All three session transcripts

Week 2 Day 1 - 28 September 2026

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Total recording time: 03:45:15

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Session 1: Sales process and prospecting

Source: GMT20260928-054719_Recording_1920x1080.mp4

Recording duration: 02:10:50. Times below are local to this recording.

00:00:00 - 00:10:00

[00:00:28 - 00:00:32]
Is anyone else alive?

[00:01:21 - 00:02:07]
She said she shared the food. What is the body yesterday? Ah, what is the body yesterday? Yeah, I was doing something. We were doing it way too hard. Very nice. Okay, we're still missing a few people, but we need to get started. So let's finish that coffee. You guys ready? Yes. So who are we missing? Who's the wall? Boogie. Medi-Mine. Boogie. Medi-Mine. Boogie. Okay. Great. Thank you so much for being here on time.

[00:02:08 - 00:02:54]
I hope you had a good rest of a Sunday. That you rested or bored. This week I will be here only today and tomorrow. Again, apologies, this is unusual. I usually am here for the full two weeks, but now we're working on launching two new funds and I have to travel more. This said, I am very much aware of what's going on, even when I'm not here, and I want to talk a little bit about that. We shared with you the dashboard. There's two sides to the dashboard. There's a dashboard that we use to track

[00:02:54 - 00:03:42]
the assignments that we would like you to work on during these first two weeks, at least to get started. There's a which we mark with red yellow green as in done done, not done, we're in progress. There's a dashboard where we track the key KPIs for each of the companies. I understand this latter one is still working progress for some of the companies, but it's very important that by the end of this week, everyone knows what are their North Star metrics or their KPIs that they're working towards in the next two months when you're working remotely. On the first part, which is the assignments for last week and this week, I will share it later.

[00:03:43 - 00:04:30]
The situation is pretty grim right now, there's a lot of people with work undone or even not started. the mentors will come to you to understand why that is, but we definitely need to work on that. So I'll show it now actually because I have another thing to cover. So this is what I'm saying. So at this point, if you look at these two first weeks, this is just to get started. we look at the first one, you know, there's a lot of people there that not started stuff or are in progress. If the in progress means that it's being discussed with the mentors and it will be soon finished, okay? But if it's in progress as in to say, I had a dream

[00:04:30 - 00:05:19]
of all it last night, therefore I started with a task, that doesn't count, okay? So again, we're, we're, I don't want to have to be looking over your shoulder, neither does the staff or the mentors and this is not this is not elementary school but we know from past experience that if you go home for week three without having these things completed the two months of experimentation that you're going to do remotely will be going to waste because you go home and then instead of like immediately starting to use our our capital in the one you raised for growth experiments you're going to still be trying to figure out who am I selling to and where are the channels that's the type of shit that needs to be

[00:05:19 - 00:06:10]
defined here it's easier to discuss it in person with us while you're here so please make like a real honest effort to get this stuff done for these first two weeks so that when you go here you're going all in on growing your companies. I started saying this a while ago but I'm repeating it more frequently here in the conferences I go to in the meetings I have for investors. You guys in all the other batches before we used to pitch your the opportunity as in in CEE, Caucasus, Central Asia, Baltics, we have super deep tech talents and all we need to do is we need to show the world that this deep tech talent can make good products.

[00:06:10 - 00:06:58]
The challenge is that in the last two years, with everyone being able to build anything at any point, very quickly with AI, this advantage that you guys used to have because you were very good deep tech talent teams is vanishing very

quickly. And the competition is definitely becoming on GTM, on sales, on distribution. This is very very important because if you don't put this in your own minds and you keep telling yourselves we're amazing technologically, our tech stack is better than anyone else, fuck these Silicon Valley guys because we're better, it doesn't matter if you're better. You would have to be a hundred times better than your US competitor for everyone else

[00:06:58 - 00:07:41]
in the world to care about you. So please make sure that you get the foundational stuff done these two weeks so that in the next two months we go all in on these distribution metrics that we want. Because we want you to come to week 11, week 12 and go on stage and have impressive growth charts or impressive logos that you signed up like impressive metrics. But you won't get there if you Any questions or comments about this? We are struggling a bit right now with pedigree, it's always in the morning.

[00:07:45 - 00:08:32]
The more time we spend on making sure we can, as soon as possible, and also modifies or integrate the tasks so we can leverage those three months and we are working on these things for sure we make good progress but it's taking away from that specific goal right now for us which is making sure we can launch a model right so that's why I think for us is we are making these things like a million programs but this is never like a step to versus making sure I can launch this and then you can go in all and all the distribution. I'll answer your question. Thank you. You're thinking about things as two different possibilities. That's why you're saying that there's nothing wrong.

[00:08:33 - 00:09:22]
But my challenge to you is that they are complementary. For example, you want to build this thing, you want to launch, but where we come in right now, by the way, guys, there's only one week left. all the time you spend here if not i think i told you in the last batches you will only join this accelerator like the ones in your life you probably joined another accelerator but this one is probably the ones i'm asking raising it that way invest let's put that into context if i'm you i'll think about this question while i'm here in the next four days five days only five days that i try to hit this target i try to build this what is it that i can download or get a different perspective You see the difference in how you can get that. You're still doing, but you're also

[00:09:22 - 00:09:59]
absorbing it in a new perspective and also you're trying to figure out different ways how to help you launch faster or to get to the results faster. So when you think about it from purely implementation point of view, it seems like this is something that's happening. But if you think a little bit longer, this is actually accelerating. Right? Yes. And all I'm trying to do is we go to the ask, we get all capital allocation, yeah obviously why time is so important especially how the world is developing class time is to balance out the best way possible to make sure we don't just learn everything and then I tell you the

00:10:00 - 00:20:00

[00:10:00 - 00:10:45]
but victor victor sorry let me interrupt you so we can use the time wisely you have three minutes left you have to put things in perspective it took you a long time to get to where you are two weeks if it was two weeks because it's five days but if it was two weeks of delaying to go live i would prefer to delay the go live two weeks and leave here with all the toolkits that you need that when you go live you just execute rather than only getting half of the value because you're here, half time in presence but then the other half time you're still thinking about the launch and then none of these two things will be well done. So I'm using you as an example but it applies to everyone else.

[00:10:45 - 00:11:29]
Delaying whatever you have to do for another week is not going to kill your company. it's better for you just kill it and that's it before i buy the money anyways let's let's let's let's forget about this now um we're gonna i need i need to start i need another 10 minutes or so okay uh first week uh first week has passed what was i want to go company by company What was the one thing that significantly changed for you or your company?

[00:11:31 - 00:12:14]
Let me reword that. What was the one thing that you significantly changed in your company because of things you've heard on week one? One thing. You can take a minute or two to think about it. I need 10 minutes. I was thinking about the metric clarity for the team. What are you doing here today? It's just a little bit. Metric clarity for the team. So we used to have different things to care about. We really got very detailed on what we tried and why in order to move the

team to get the honest business.

[00:12:16 - 00:13:02]
Metric clarity for the team. Clarity for the team. In roles, responsibilities, organization? Yeah, basically engineering and also to do operations, all in all what we have to do and why. And everyone is aligned and everyone is responsible, everyone is possible. Yeah, this is actually a super important point because often times as we start growing the companies, I felt this when I was doing my companies, some people are not super motivated to do their things faster because they don't understand the impact that those things have on the company's success, especially for development. Why the fact am I doing this line of code? Why am I doing the landing page this way? Because I don't love it, I'd rather do it that way. So it's very important at this stage when the teams are very small

[00:13:02 - 00:13:51]
to make sure that everyone understands their direct contribution to the bottom line or to the top line or to whatever is your KPI. For us I think we went back and challenged a few assumptions we had from the beginning and we understood, look, experiment more into even your fundamentals, your pricing, your landing page and base your decision on the data you get from these factors. We haven't done this in various aspects. we have done this for some but not some of the core aspects for the region. Okay, very important. It's exactly what we want especially with week one but also week two is to question all your assumptions even if it's just to confirm that they were right.

[00:13:51 - 00:14:41]
I agree. Sorry Julie. Not to be metrics. For us it was very important to realize that we need to live very quickly to meet clients and we are in active stage of pilots now. And we got the framework of success plan before onboarding and commitment on success metrics with the client before we even sign. And this will allow us to manage expectations for those sites. And we were not even thinking about it. Can you say it differently? I didn't understand. We were jumping on signing the contracts with clients without thinking on how to deliver value from our platform quickly. And we always had cases where we were onboarding clients, but not in a client scale.

[00:14:42 - 00:15:32]
When do we meet them? What will they receive from us? At which point? And I feel now like we have control of what we're going to do with them. Otherwise we will just, with scanning, go to the cows. Okay, so contracting versus onboarding, timing it better and making sure that you know what you need to deliver. So you have the opposite challenge of most people you were selling first and figuring it out later. Okay, good problem to have. Yes? For me it was because many times we like know what we should do or how things work, but we really not write those flows, the marketing flows and the company flows,

[00:15:32 - 00:16:18]
how the customer comes from B to point Z. Also, it really can help you see the gaps and what we need to work on. So for me this was like maybe one of the biggest things to really write the flow down, marketing flow, funnels, so we really see on paper, not just think about these things. So for me this was like really like eye open and smooth head. Documenting things is definitely very very important especially for those of you who are doing this almost alone. We may have other people like on your side, right? I think we very much, with Justina, I think I wanted to validate that our approach is correct at the beginning of where we are actually going right now.

[00:16:19 - 00:17:05]
Yes, we have the agents and everything, but where we go right now, I think we have the experts at our team a lot more, and I feel a lot more confidence that what we are doing right now has the value. there are a lot of problems associated with our customers, which even for the problem stuff I kind of knew here in my mind, writing them down so clearly, because now that's a lot of really understanding between one and one of our consumers. And I think the biggest, biggest thing was that yes, this direction is in a direction for a short time. We are agreeing that the most important method for us is retention, hard time, conversion

[00:17:05 - 00:17:49]
from pilots to customers and it will show us that we are closer to our work and moreover we clarify that like let's say predictive metrics that can show us that we really deliver the value for our actual clients and it's very important because our goal is to go to the stage and show that look like this is our clients, customers after the pilot and because they are growing. This is everyone. I see everyone typing on their laptops.

[00:17:50 - 00:18:38]
It's because I'm feeling at being a good speaker. It's my fault, not your fault. But I'll try to get better and be more

exciting. This point that Dimitri made is very important. These days in AI, one of the things that investors are looking at is is pilot to client conversion. this sounds obvious, everyone wanted conversion from pilot to paid, but the thing is now with AI there's so much more pilots and it's so much easier to start pilots that pilots are no longer a relevant metric or very very almost not relevant. It's this conversion that you mentioned that is very important. So as much as you can do you need to stay on top of who's doing the pilot, how are

[00:18:39 - 00:19:29]
because you did better onboarding and you know what they expect about the pilot and you are on a daily basis or weekly basis depending on how long the pilot is checking in on that even if you just like a quick call hey how's it going are you getting it are you not so in you've heard you know you know, or if you haven't you should have heard, Paul Brands saying that you know do things that don't scale until you can scale. This is the type of things that you have to do at the pilot level to make sure that you will get paid by it. sometimes it's better to have fewer pilots listen to this it's better sometimes have fewer pilots now of high quality with lots of hand holding to

[00:19:29 - 00:20:00]
make sure that you have a high conversion rate from pilots to pay then having a hundred pilots and then only one percent of us Got it? Thank you for not typing while I say that. Okay, who am I missing? My point is to say about pilots, so I make sure it is a bunch of white pilots and a person. So this is my grandmother. Okay.

00:20:00 - 00:30:00

[00:20:00 - 00:20:50]
And another thing is how it's going to be positioned in the environment. This is also important for me. I have presented water and how I am not saying this to the world and the pilot will be too to work in two years, I mean, if it had a real estate, I would assure that there is a good deliverance for the house. Okay, thank you. I can't agree with all the things that you just mentioned, but maybe one thing, actually it's a bit deeper, that we have an approach of being rest of the best and, you know, disrupting the industry and so on. and actually it does not need trust, so it's just scary for our customers it seems to be

[00:20:51 - 00:21:38]
and I think we do not need to be smarter than our customers, just serving them properly and this will give us and it changed a lot of things like it gives us a better focus that while we are doing something, can we are doing something else? because we think that's a good idea because we can justify it based on customer feedback that that's how we can pay them for one dollar. Yes so if someone related with some of the things we already said about you know treating pilots properly treating the onboarding properly so you know what they're expecting therefore you're delivering to them in the short term. I want to add one more thing here and then we can get back up for today.

[00:21:39 - 00:22:22]
Or for now, or for a week. Everything you said this morning, a lot of what I said this morning may make you believe that everything you should do now is a lot of hand holding, a lot of making sure the clients get what they want and that is true, but there is a time limit to that. So at one point you do have to start doing things that don't scale to do things that scale. Learning or finding out where you do that is as much an art as it is a science and it's something that you can do with us.

[00:22:25 - 00:23:14]
But if you think about your fundraising timeline, and I'll pledge time today and we'll talk about this again. If you think about your fundraising milestones, from now until your next race, for most of you, it will definitely matter that you did these things that don't scale and you have a high conversion to pay and you have clients that are giving you high ratings or referring you to others or they're allowing you to put your logos on your sales materials it's more important than having you know 50% growth rate week on week especially if that 50% growth rate week on week is not reflected in revenue just use your growth but not revenue

[00:23:14 - 00:23:59]
right so let's continue working on this making sure that between now and your next fundraising milestone you have in that fundraising milestone or deadline I mean the things that you need at that time in at lunchtime I will talk about what are the things that you need at that time okay 10 minutes I want to give you time. 10 seconds. Pedro said, Matrix needs something done this week. I want to square you the way we do today. So in office hours, if you guys want to vote me, whatever, describe me. Five minutes, we make a decision and go. So I want to square you the way today.

Everybody know.

[00:24:00 - 00:24:07]
I know we've done it myself, but come again. We are out there. Thank you. Thank you, everyone.

[00:24:20 - 00:25:06]
Okay. I'm just going to ask you guys to not be on your computer. So all we're chatting is 90 minutes and they give me our undivided attention for 90 minutes. So if you can do that, that would be lovely if you need to call or do something. Go outside, it's going to be distracting and it will be distracting. And I'll probably just scare you and put it right back on that. Yeah? Okay. So for this week, I'm going to tell you about what we're doing this week. So we have aligned expectations around what we're going to do for each session. So today we're going to do an overview. And the reason that I want to do an overview first is because I want to make sure we're talking about the same thing and we're aligned in talking about what the buying process looks like, what creating ICPs looks like, and what value propositions for customers look like.

[00:25:06 - 00:25:53]
And the value propositions will be the most important thing you do today. You have your value proposition, hopefully. Are you done? I want to let you see them. You have yours, everyone? Yes? OK. So today we're going to do customer value propositions. And the customer value propositions that you do today, you're going to use tomorrow. You're going to use at the end of the week. On Thursday and Friday, when you do sales demos, you're going to use them every time you talk to customers. You're going to use them for the rest of your work. that you're providing to customers instead of your futures. If you take away one thing from this week, I hope they take away that you stop talking about futures and you stop talking about value. So today, we're going to do an overview. We're going to do customer value propositions and ICPs. And so we'll leave with that from the day today. Tomorrow, we have two sessions.

[00:25:53 - 00:26:40]
We do outbound in the morning. So we talk about messaging, using our value propositions from today. And in the afternoon, we do discovery calls. So what's your discovery calls, scripts, and all of those It's usually different than what you guys have been doing if you do a workshop in the afternoon. We have two separate ones split so don't skip the afternoon because it's a very different session. Yes? On Thursday we're going to do sales demos. So I'll have a talk about how to run a sales demo, how to do it, like how to interact with your customers. And then on Friday you guys will be doing a mini version of your sales demo to the group. They'll have 10 minutes, 7 to 10 minutes. Yes? An actual demo, like a customer. I'll be your customer. Just tell me who I am, right? And then you'll present it. Ultimately, if you are not B2B, I know some of you are doing B2C here doing things, like the same funnel, the same flow, every value that I talk about, you will do for investors.

[00:26:40 - 00:27:26]
You can do the investor flow, right? Doesn't matter to me if you want to do that instead, or you want to do both of them and you want feedback on both, great. Also, you all know I talk a little fast. If you need me to slow down and repeat something, just like way to be interactive, yes. Also stop me through the questions, be interactive. I know you'll love listening to me for 90 minutes, but like I would like this to be interactive and have you guys chat and not just listen to this on the byways. Yes? Perfect. Okay, great. And we have team members that we wanted to join for the sales session online. Anyone have anyone they invited? Hopefully maybe Kato? Yes, I want to speak. Okay. You know the sales session in sales demo? Sorry? What do you mean sales session? Oh, for right now. Just the session we're doing now. Like if there's anyone else on your team, the salesperson or someone else that's not here that you would like to attend the session.

[00:27:26 - 00:28:14]
just have them join virtually. It's recorded if you want, but I know Kato wants to attend. So if anyone wants to know. Okay, perfect. Perfect, perfect. Okay, so today. Okay, so today we're defining B2B sales and what that means and how to think about it differently. We'll talk about the buyer's journey, right, and thinking about how your customers purchase things because how you sell and how they buy are very different things. And usually people don't think about how people buy and they're thinking with other customers they're just thinking about their next steps um icp and customer value propositions and we'll also talk about stakeholders um and again whether you're selling to a business where you whether you're partnering with someone right or if you're doing partnerships you're going to do the same process um and you'll talk about value the same way um okay so first we're going

[00:28:14 - 00:29:03]
to talk about defining b2b sales just so we're on the same on the same page right when we're talking about b2b sales we're talking about usually selling to an organization with multiple stakeholders right you'll have a couple stakeholders sometimes there's one very rarely there's one there's way often more than one right there might be six there might be 20 there might be 50 there's a lot of stakeholders involved right and so we're thinking about that and thinking about how we manage all those relationships and how we move those forward even if you don't talk to all the stakeholders right they're talking internally without you right and so you need to think about how you're part of conversations that they're having. You have a little longer sales cycle, right? And we'll talk about transactional versus a complex sale and the difference between those and thinking about where you fall on that. A demo during the sales cycle, right? Usually it could be a B2B sale. You have

[00:29:03 - 00:29:50]
some sort of demo, whether it's a created demo or you end up doing a demo with the customer. Tads for larger deals. Something that often happens because people want to see what it looks like first. Or you need to do a lot of setup and pre-work and so you want them to commit to something you do all of the setup for them for a shorter time. You must track conversion metrics to be successful. So we'll go over a little bit today, but we'll have a separate session where we talk about the sales funnel and what you should be tracking in your CRM to make sure that you're tracking all the things that you should be tracking to make sure that you hold yourself or the other salespeople accountable. Yep. And then sales are based on solving a business problem, right? They're not based on features. They're not based on how cool your product is. They're not based on like how good your website is and how innovative and fine your technology is.

[00:29:50 - 00:30:00]
It's always based on a problem. Business is fine to solve a problem and you should always be speaking to the problem solved. Always, always, right? Um, when we're thinking about

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[00:30:00 - 00:30:45]
our funnel and what it looks like you're going to see this a million times with me because we're going to talk about different stages in different places has everyone seen like a funnel like this before ish a little bit okay so on our left we have like what our outbound um what our outbound looks like right so you have like identify your markets you're building your icp you're identifying your stakeholders you're finding contacts you're doing a bunch of research, prospecting, right, and you qualify your leads and it turns into a sales qualified lead, which we'll talk about more tomorrow because you'll be doing this on your discovery calls, right, into down-level negotiation one. And on the right, you have your marketing funnel, right, and so you should be tracking these separately, and again, we'll talk about tracking your funnel metrics in another session, but having your outbound and having your inbound, which is your marketing.

[00:30:46 - 00:31:34]
So marketing is also bringing leads in to the same channel. you have your marketing qualified leads and then your sales qualify them and then they go on the funnel yes no questions okay fantastic okay some common sales mistakes i like to go over these at the beginning because someone said everyone makes um everyone is our customer everyone could use our product our product is so good that everyone could use it yes i'm sure they definitely can however right not everyone is your best customer right now right you spread your resources too thin you spread your team too thin, you don't message to the right people if you're trying to target everyone at once. So we really want to focus our ICPs. I talked with some of you last week about really targeting our ICPs and being very, very specific about them. I'll talk about ICPs in a little bit more about how to do that, but I really want you to focus and narrow in on a very, very narrow market

[00:31:34 - 00:32:20]
to make sure that you're speaking the right language to the right people and solving the problem they have. Another one, hiring sales reps too early, right? Also very common. Founders are like, oh, I'm going to this new market. I'm going to go to E-box, I'm going to hire E-box rep, and they're just going to sell a little degree. That very, very rarely works out, right? If you don't know the market, if you don't know the space, if you don't know the messaging, if you don't know the problems that they're solving, it's unrealistic to bring in someone else to do the same, right? And so when you're hiring sales people, you're setting them up, you have to have done it first, right? to be successful, to be

able to show them what to do or how to align expectations on what to do next. Building before selling, right? This is a more common with technical patterns. When you're like, I'm going to tell them the same piece, tell them the same way thing and everyone's going to love it.

[00:32:20 - 00:33:05]
And then there's definitely a user product because we built this really cool thing, right? Making sure that actually the market that you're going after, that you're solving a problem before, wants the thing before you build it. That a couple people want it before you build it, yeah. And then competing on price. It's really easy. What if I just give them 20% off? I'm going to talk to them and then they'll buy it because they're cheaper than the other one. We don't want to be a product that's a race to the bottom. If you raise to the bottom, then the other person, who might have more money, either fundraise more or they're just a bigger company, they're like, well, we'll go 30% off. And then you're both racing to the bottom to just compete on price. We don't want to compete just on price. So you want to compete on that. You want to compete on the value that you're bringing to people. Right? And sometimes it can be something as easy as like, we have a phenomenal onboarding.

[00:33:06 - 00:33:55]
Right? We send someone to your office. We have someone that goes through with your team, sets it up, sends everything up, walks you through it. Because sometimes larger companies are starting to raise a bunch of money. Just give people a product and they're like, be free. See how it goes. And it's really hard for the customer to onboard. They're like, onboarding is terrible. We actually never used it. We paid for it for a year and we didn't use it. Right? didn't have a good onboarding so sometimes something as simple as a better more structured onboarding can win you a customer over someone else yes so thinking about that um when we are thinking about the different types of sales and thinking about where you are who's seen like who thinks they're a transactional sale has anyone thought at all like which type of sale you are because that's complex yeah more okay

[00:33:55 - 00:34:41]
Okay, who feels like they fall more over here on Transactional? Okay, who feels like they fall more complex? Okay, who thinks they're going to help? You have both. Yeah, you have both. Okay, right, when it's transactional you have like one decision maker, one or two decision makers, a low contract value, and it depends on your region in terms of like what the contract value is, right? Like in the Bay Area, you're pretty transactional if you're under a 2K a month. You're pretty much a transactional sale, right? If you're over that anymore, then you're usually more of a complex sale. There's more stakeholders involved. But in different areas, right, that might be different. It might be $200 a month, $50, wherever you're going, thinking about how you're selling to the customers and thinking about the stakeholders that you have.

[00:34:41 - 00:35:28]
Your complex sale, if you're selling to a government, if you're selling to an enterprise, if you're selling to anyone with a logo that other people recognize, complex right um usually people end up having a couple different sales cycles that you're tracking in your phone right so you're having your more transactional ones which maybe if you're selling smbs mid-market accounts right you have your funnel set up because you know that they're going to close within 30 days um you have to talk to one or two people you know what the process is like you have a couple meetings and they're closing versus your complex one you're like this might take six to nine months to close right we have to meet with 15 people we have to have these stakeholder meetings to have this like review deck we have to have almost like a business review of what we're doing what we're doing next we have to have proposed plan for business outcomes and we have to get

[00:35:28 - 00:36:12]
exactly design right that would be a more complex sale so when you're thinking about like where you are on the process that you have when you have multiple people doing sales on your team also thinking about who is best for each one right maybe someone who's really good at transactional sales right when you're hiring a salesperson when you're interviewing and thinking about who um usually people's experience or background fall in one or two. They're more transactional rep and they're used to high turnover deals like going very quickly or they're on the enterprise larger deal side and they're used to multiple stakeholders like longer deal cycles and process. And you want to make sure that you hire the one that fits. That fits you, not just like a salesperson who's good at selling. You want to find someone who's sold in the same way that your product is sold now.

[00:36:14 - 00:37:00]
To allow them where you are. Any questions? I'm really kind of fine so far. Just soaking it in. So if you want me to

climb in. Okay. Okay. Let's start the buying process. Okay. So typical buying process. Let's talk about what the buying process looks like traditionally when they're thinking about buying something, right? At the very, very beginning, they need to learn that they have a problem, right? They need to understand that there's a problem that they need to solve. If they don't understand there's a problem they need to solve, then they need to learn that they have a problem to solve, right? If you're trying to sell to someone who doesn't think they have a problem, that's going to take you a really long time to close them. Because you not only have to teach them about your product, you have to teach them that they have the problem that your product solves, right? So when you're talking to anyone, any potential customer, I want you to think about where they're at and what they know.

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Right? So they'll learn. And then after they say, OK, I do have this problem. I have a problem. I need to solve it. Now I need to figure out what I actually need to solve this problem, right? And that usually involves talking to other people within the team, right? Making a list of like priorities of things they need to do, even if it's in their head, right? Maybe it's not written down, it's just in their head like, okay, we have this problem with our team. What do we need to have to solve it, right? And then they go out and they explore. And they're like, who would solve this problem for me? I have this problem. I know kind of what I need. Now I'm going to go talk to a bunch of people to find it out, right? So when you're talking to people, are you talking to them when they're exploring options, right? Are they talking to multiple competitors of yours? Did they happen to see you and they're like, oh, I actually think we have this problem, but you're the first one we're talking to?

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Are they still trying to understand their needs? So like, oh, we feel like we need a Sierra. Like most of you right now are probably like, you shouldn't have a Sierra, I'm gonna move off the spreadsheets. And you're like, what Sierra should we use? Right? You're like figuring out what you need, what fits, what fits up at this moment, right? And your customers are thinking the same. For different things, right? They're evaluating options, right? everything right let's look at the prices and the functionality features let's look at like what people say about them reviews online let's see what the ongoing looks like let's see how long people stay with them right they won't understand like okay let's evaluate what this substance is like they make an internal case right especially if you're a more complex bill they usually don't have the budget that they can just sign off on right if it's under 2k right 2k a month like

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Usually people can sign off on it, if you're talking about a higher person. Like a director or a VC can sign off on that. But higher than that, they have to make an internal case to see this is what we're going to get from it. Here's how it solves the problem we have. And this is what I'd like to do. And sometimes you're involved in those, and sometimes you're not. Sometimes those happen without you. You should try to be involved in them, but sometimes it happens without you. And then it goes through the finance team. And the finance guys are the ones who are always like, And then sometimes they'll come back and say, can we get a discount on something on this? Like our like-minded guy doesn't like this. Right? Our CFO is like, can you get something else? Because that's their job. Your job is to push back. Like, can you go back? Especially at larger corporations, right?

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That's what they like to do. In most of the cases, they ask for them without WTO finance. Yes. Yeah. They ask for? What's done without WTO? Oh, yeah. Yeah. Some of them also, but the finance team will also do a lot because they're just like, we should ask a little bit more. Okay, great. Perfect. And then they confirm, like, okay, we're confirming, we're going to do this thing, we're paying this much, we're paying 50k for this amount, going to order to get this value, signed off agreed, and then you finally get the payment, right? Like stimulus or the pulse? That was my supposed day. Like sign off, yeah, because also often, right, like if it's something that's more expensive, if you have a more complex sale and it's a larger ticket item, the person that you're talking to might not be the one that signs it. It might be someone else that signs it that you don't talk to, right? And so it goes to them

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to sign. Depending on who you're talking to, right, and where you are, or like where you are on the stage, if you're more transactional still, like, it's probably the person that you're talking to, right? If it's more complex now, and you're selling something that's like 50, 100K, like, probably it's someone else that's going to sign it, right, that's going to like sign off on it and agree to it. So then it still goes to someone else outside of the direct person that you're talking to. And so depending on where you're at, right, or who's the one who's pushing it. We'll talk about stakeholders a little bit later to identify where in the buying process each person is or who you're talking to in the buying process. Right? So in the buying during process, there's all these things that happen, right? We're here, we're like, oh, I have a problem, right? We're like, oh, they need to identify, no, they have a problem. And then when they're understanding their needs, they're like, what is important to me? What's important to my business? What do we need

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to have? What's the next to have? Right? What are some things we need to think about? Did we buy something already and it went terribly and we spent a bunch of money and don't actually Did we try to solve this problem internally already and we couldn't build it and it never got off? We spent three months building this and it was not successful. What are the things that they're thinking about when they're trying to understand their needs? Because it's never like, here's this magical problem that just dropped and now we need to solve it. It's like other things have happened for them within the business, within the company that you should understand to set yourself up to be most successful. So many things happen when they're trying to understand their needs and when they're exploring options. especially in a more complex sale, get involved. And I'm like, no, I heard bad things about that company.

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Or I saw these people at a conference and I want to talk to them. Or I have a friend that works over here, so we should try this one, right? Or I saw this thing online, I went to this webinar. Like, there's a lot of voices that are being heard, right? That are talking about like when they're understanding these different people might be different than those different companies. It might not be the same person, right? And when you're going through and you're thinking about like, who are all the people that are involved in this decision? one person and you have to understand what's happening internally, right, before you give them a demo. Absolutely before demo. I'm so curious, like bigger companies, when they look at some type of solution in the market, do they actually fight internally? We should build this ourselves versus we should

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go to this company. Is that like an internal crash that doesn't happen by them companies? There's like a build versus buy, right? your discovery call and we'll talk about discovery call tomorrow and like how to identify some of those. Like you're identifying, have you used something before, right? Did it go well or not well? Probably not well because you're talking to me, right? If they didn't use something before, did they try to build it internally? Are they deciding between building it themselves or buying externally? Because you need to figure out like where you fall. If you're competing with an internal build, right, that's a different discussion because then you're like, okay, If you have two engineers building this and a PM, you're probably spending half a million dollars to build it. Plus you have to maintain it yourself. So then your competition, right? You're like, I know you want to spend half a million dollars to build this.

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You could build it, but we already built it for you. And it's like 10K a month, right? Which is significantly cheaper than you building and managing internally. But that's a different discussion than if you're like, we know we want to buy something internally. And we're evaluating all the options. We want to see if there's something that's a good fit. talking to three of you at once, we're going to run three pilots and see which one's the better outcome. Which you also want to know because you want to know who you're competing against, who they're comparing against, because you don't just want to run a blind pilot. And you're like, great, go for two weeks, for a month, and hopefully you like it. Hopefully it's good, let us know if you have problems. No. You want to know how they're judging you, right? If you don't know, then it's just like you're just crossing your fingers, hoping at the end of the day they like you more than others, right? Then you're not being consultative throughout and helping them understand and decide, right?

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more consultative and you want to be good with them to help them think about and decide what the best decision would be. Right? Good question. But yes, that happens all the time. Fireballs. When they're evaluating options, right,

and they're debating like who is there, there's a lot of politics that happens internally, right? When people are thinking about what should next or what they like or who has the budget or whose budget it's coming from and things that you might not know but you can ask some questions around right to try to find out like what's happening internally like who's owning the budget who's owning the outcome right what the success looks like and who gets that success when it happens right and sometimes when you're competing with people it might be that someone's already like i already like these other guys because they're my friends but we have to evaluate other options so you're evaluating them but you might not know that they already really like this

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other company more that that also happens all the time right um or people are trying to keep the business they have but they're already working with someone but they're like we want to explore their options and see what else is there if you don't ask you don't know that they've tried something or currently working with someone you don't know you're going to think against them but you also don't know what their interaction was like and what happened within there and so tons of things happen there like internally that you are maybe thinking about maybe not thinking about when you're trying to understand what their writing process looks like right and then times you're purchasing there's some blockers right so some people are like it's not closed one until they send money right because sometimes something happens the CEO might be like no actually we're not gonna buy anything for the rest of this quarter it didn't get signed we're not buying it like we can talk about it if you want

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but we're not buying anything else in Q4 right but we all agree and if you had just done it like last week we could have signed it it would have been fine right because just sometimes like right internal things happen so understanding like the priorities of the company when they're doing things and making sure that you understand as much as possible about the landscapes you don't get long sighted there or the bi-imitating right find the students like actually they already spent their budget you thought it could it doesn't but you have to wait three months right now we didn't ask about this earlier like had no idea sometimes things happen that you can't prepare for but you can do a good job of understanding the landscape and your internal customer's landscape of where they are understanding who cares about what, understanding whose metrics are important to whom within the organization, right? And understanding the relationships within them. Yes? Yes? Who's been thinking about their customer response process?

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A lot of people. Okay. Yeah? Mostly? Good. Do you mostly want most of it? And so when we're thinking about a more complex sale, right? And the reason I put this here is because the other one is like super simple, right? When we're like, oh, there's just some things that could happen that you should think about. There are so many more things that happen, right, on the customer's side that you don't see. Because you meet with them, what, a couple times on a call. Some stakeholders come on the call. But there's so many more things that happen, right? They're like, when they're identifying the problem, right? They're like, okay, we have this problem. If you're selling to a large enterprise or corporation, they have to create a deck, right? They have to create a deck to them. This is a problem that we need to solve, that we're going to solve. And here's our plan to solve the problem. And we think we're going to solve it by the end of the quarter, right?

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Or by somewhere else. They're like, OK. So the executives know that there's problems. So they're thinking about a budget or putting money aside for a moment. And the person is doing online research. They're looking for information. They're downloading white papers. They're maybe attending some webinars. Right? And then they're like, is this a problem? But now I'm reading more things about how this is not a problem, that other people actually have this other problem that's not just a problem. I thought I had. So maybe now I have three problems. instead of one problem, right? And so they're like, are these actually my problems or not my problems, right? And so then they're like, well now I'm overwhelmed because there's 20 companies trying to do the same thing and how do I choose? How do I choose which one is gonna be the one that's a good fit for me? Because all of them approximately say they do the same thing, right? So we're talking about our value propositions

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and how you're different, right? And how you fit differently, like that is so important because when the customer is going in, looking at research, right? You see 20 of the same companies and you're all like, we solve problems in the same way. Like we are your sales AI. And you're like, cool, there's 200 sales agents. How do I pick the sales agents? Right? How do I choose? What was your question? I know it's individual, but like what's the title of the whole big of a

company has this title? By your journey, let's say, about 10 days, 100 plus 20 years or like? Oh, I feel like even less than that. But I feel like once you get to like 30 to 50 people, you start having like, not all of the things, but you start having like competing priorities.

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And people have to allocate their budget to certain things. And you have to prioritize and decide like which problem is the one that you should solve right now. Right? And people, but even at a small company, right? A 10 person company. If I'm like 10 person company, maybe I have like two salespeople. And I'm like, oh, a lot of companies are having companies sales AI agents again. I've been like these virtual AI agents to help with sales. I want to see if we can do it. And then I'm like, OK, let me go look. And then there's so many companies that all say they're like a virtual SDR. How do I choose between who is going to be the best fit for me? And now because there are so many people creating more and more things, if your language isn't differentiated, if you're not talking about how your value proposition is different. right let's say that I'm a let's say I'm a dentist and I go and search them like

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dentist CRM or like dentist AI right like if you don't have that wording if you don't have that content available when I go and search that even if you could do it even if your product could service that if I don't see that this is the CRM for dentists like I'm not gonna I'm not gonna buy the product right and so when we're talking about our ICPs and talking about being very very specific not just so you know but still like you can create that content and messaging to really target each person, right? Because if you say you're a CRM for everyone, right? If I'm a dentist or if I am a

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solo founder or if i'm a team of like 50 right those are all going to be very different messaging right and understand that differently but so there's so many things that happen even think about like the last software you guys bought or things that you looking at how did you decide what to buy this is definitely more transactional sale right somebody posted on x somebody posted on x and you were like okay i trust you i'll buy it no i did like I have three more steps to rewrite by . OK. Did you look at any competitors? Just specifically previous. Any more x-posts if somebody else is talking about it? It's pretty much . It's just . It works.

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Yeah. Yeah, from someone that you trusted. This is like one version decision. So this is a different . Yeah. What if you are like a marketing product, or something where you have more people that are more engaging or involved in it, right? Do you guys talk about it as co-founders? Yeah. And I think the one thing we are missing right now, more and more decisions are delegated to AI. So when I evaluate themselves, I'm just writing a code when I'm trying to solve my specific situation, and I'm just asking what kind of solutions might be. And then my choice is basically among these top three. And I already have a winner among those three who is the best fit into my specific situation.

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So that's the kind of evaluation that is happening right now. You need to be in this evaluation otherwise you might not be able to discuss it. Yeah, so imagine a working company because more people are using AI, but like you guys, I would say, are more early adopters. Like a lot of people, if you're selling to an enterprise or a corporate, depending on the team, not all of them are active. Yeah, users, right? And so you'll have some people that do that, that are like, hey, clock, I should use these two things. And someone else is like, yeah, but I did research and I think that these three other companies will be actually best for us in their life. And right? And then they're like, okay, now we have to evaluate them all. What are we going to evaluate them on? what we should do right and so there's so many things happening like inside right when we talk about stakeholders we'll talk about what each type of

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person cares about as you start thinking about them but there's a lot of things happening internally right inside your company and you don't know their process and how they buy things how they bought other software in the past it's hard for you to navigate right because then you end up with things like that for more information so I sent over that or they ask they want to talk about internally And so I sent them a PDF and now I'm just waiting. And you're just waiting. You're just waiting because there's things happening that you didn't ask about. You're not in the conversation. You don't know what they're evaluating. You don't know what they're looking at. And so if you don't know what they're doing and how you can help them be supportive, it's very, very hard for you to move the deal forward. Then again,

you're just crossing your fingers and you're like, hopefully you come back to me. We don't want to be done. We don't want to manage the process.

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OK, so the typical selling process. Very simple again. them, you contact them, they come in, inbound, you have a discovery call, you map the org, you have some stakeholders on the demo, folks will negotiate you onboard them. Pretty simple, right? You're like, here's how we're thinking, here's how we're thinking what our process is. But then we're thinking about them, you're like, hmm, how's our process along with their volume process? Do we align? No, the callers align. Do the work align, right? When we're like, oh, they're like learning, they're understanding their needs, and we're like, let's get on a discovery call. Do you have this problem? What are you doing? Do you have I'm not going to be talking about features. It's really lovely, it's really great. Right, and they're like, we're actually exploring options, okay. We're just, we're just wanna see what's out there. We just wanna see what you guys do.

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We're just like learning, right? And you're like, let's move this over though. Don't you wanna try it? Do you wanna pilot? Right? No, we're no, we're just, we're just looking at it, right? And so I want you to think about like where you are, right? Because of tracking your sales, right? And thinking about your next step. they are and they're next in it. Because if you're pushing for like let's do a demo and they're like I don't know if this isn't my problem yet actually. Then you don't want to push them to a demo. You need to understand and make sure that you are aligning with them and their process of like you have this problem, we can absolutely solve it, let me show you how we solve it. And also I want to understand what your budget is, what that looks like, what success looks like for you, how you buy software internally, right?

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And we'll talk more about those tomorrow. I'll help you write some questions in the script. We're understanding the buying process, right? Some things, some of you it seems like know a little bit more about your business buying process. Some I think are maybe like kind of learning and thinking about this a little bit more. And the same when you're going, when you're fundraising, right? You want to understand the exact same things. So same funnel, keep in your CRM also, have your investment funnel. What are the pain points, right? What is the level of the organization? You want to know what they care about? You want to know how they make decisions? You want to know what else they've got, right? And so I know you did user interview questions, which is seeing you last week, right? If you don't know how a lot of your companies work internally and what they do, these are good things to ask and understand, right? So you can start mapping out the organization.

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If you're selling into a new industry that you don't know, right? These are things that you should find out, right? MBA intern that's in here that's just like their project is to do an analysis of all these products and put it together in a report because then you're pretty far from getting something sold. Right? Because probably their own project. Right? They're going to go through it all together. They have no buying authority whatsoever. Right? It will be very interesting and they'll ask you a lot of questions and it will take a lot of your time. Right? We're thinking about the buying process. Right? Thinking about how many demo calls you've done with them. Right? Like how many stakeholders are on the demo calls? you have the first line person, then you have the next one, and you have to do another type of demo, and then you may put another one with a technical one with some technical

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team members on it. Keeping track of how you're going through the process for your different market segments is really important. Did they evaluate other companies? What content did they find relevant? Did you have to send a proposal to get approved before the contract, or could you just send the contract over? A lot of transactions you can send an account to go through from you and a proposal. But a lot of large companies want a proposal, right? And they want their lawyers to redline it, they're going to comment on it, they'll do some things before you can get some money. Were there other companies doing a pilot at the same time? Again, a lot of enterprise companies would love to do this. They'll do like five to seven pilots at once, and they'll just compare them all across. And if you don't know, you're just going online. You have a set of current pilots, they're going to pay for a bunch.

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And if you don't know, then you don't know what metrics you're up against. How many people were involved in approving? Who signed the contract and what were the problems they're trying to solve? You should know all of these things during the interview. Tomorrow we'll talk about in the discovery call questions to ask DHM. But you should not

be doing a demo if you don't know the answers to all these questions. You should be learning and understanding either in the discovery call or in some customer interviews to understand the space and understand the stakeholders and people that you're talking to. So the best practice is not to do demo after discovery equations. You do the demo separately. And separately. It's easier to do separate. If you're a very, very good salesperson, you can take what you've learned in discovery and kind of custom do a demo for them, like on the fly.

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Or if you've done a bunch and you're like, OK, if it's more transactional and you're like, this is the same industry, the same fit, I can do this demo, and it's the same, then you can do it. But generally, you want to prepare and prep for the demo. someone else on because if a discover call is used with one person what you don't want to also do is get stuck in the trap where you can demo after demo after demo after demo after demo because there's different persons who are like oh this person needs to see it. No this person needs to see it. Let's all just get on the call so I don't have to do 5,000 of these right. And so you always want to do the demo after you understand the process, right? Or else you're, again, you're flying blind, right? Then you're going into the demo and you're like, let me show you a bunch of cool stuff and hopefully you like it. And if you like it, then you'll hopefully you'll probably get it. Right? And that is like you're throwing spaghetti against the wall, right?

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You want to go into your demo saying, I understand your pain points. I understand you as the buyer. I know how your buying process internally is going to work. I know how I can solve this problem for you. for you, what the outcome is going to be, what that looks like, right? And so then they're like, yes, this is exactly what's our problem. And they're like, fantastic. I also know internally what our next steps are. So we can try our next steps after the demo, right? The demo is not here's much of my cool stuff. The demo is confirming the problem, showing them how to solve it, and then . Yeah, the demo is pretty much the same. It's basically a . I am always having a hard time to explain the value of getting another demo to show the same

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basically because it's even easier for us to get through the demos themselves rather than be showing it through the screen share. The question is what should we do in that situation? Do we really need this kind of demo demo? Do people purchase right after saying that first demo? Most of the time we have only one call and this call is basically a discovery call for me. And then the demo thing, it goes to the demos themselves. We see the report in the Slack channel, through the document, because we have

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an application, the person from the company went through the data. And yeah, so I usually can show either the champion or the stakeholder on the first goal for the discovery goal. So the screen share that looks like you guys go ahead and test it. So your demo, also we'll talk about demos more on Thursday too, but But your demo is not the same as your product demo. You're not showing them all of the functionality and all of the features and things that they can do. It's only showing, this is what you're interested in. If you've seen it already, if anyone hasn't seen it, I'm happy to show you some features and functionality of it. If it's a larger client and you're like, here's how we support enterprises in a different way.

[01:00:45 - 01:01:31]
Here's how this is structured and set up. Here's maybe some things that they have questions on things that they're doing to show them. Maybe part of it is part of the product, part of it is maybe like a slide of like showing like either conversion metrics or things that happen that change. But like your demo is like in general, right? Demo is just showing people what they care about to see to solve the problem that they have. It's not like, here's how you log in, you can log in and all these things. Here's your analytics and here's, no, right? They don't care about analytics yet. They care about solving their problem. The analytics are like this thing they want to see later, right? Or if you know that usually people like you want to know how we connect with this or how we get leads to their sales team. Let me show you how easy it is to get leads to your sales team because that's you don't show them the demo. That's like they turn on the back. And you're like this is what this and that looks like.

[01:01:31 - 01:02:24]
So there's probably things that you could show them or things that they care about or things that they like that are

different from just the demo. But you don't have to re-show the whole demo. You should not show the whole demo. No one should be showing the whole demo of their whole product at any demo ever. right? Have you heard the term show up and throw up? Very common phrase because a lot of sales reps come and they come and call them like here's all my things, here's all my features, all this stuff, and who you want to buy? And they talk for like 30 minutes and they're like and we do it to buy now, right? No, we don't need to buy now, right? So that's not what we want to do. But we'll talk more about like what to create a few of your demo on how to show up and what it should look like. But it should be very interactive and it should be like here's what people see success in, here's questions people have, here's what we were asking, here's how we set it up on the back end, here's what this looks like, here's what onboarding looks like, more of the setup things that they were using the product.

[01:02:25 - 01:03:12]
Good question. So it's a question we have been thinking a lot lately. So you are in this demo with a large client and we also do this for big business. In this demo we try to find the brain points. So we try to show them how the thing is over. How much is it on the demo? And how many you find in the product you show the brain point with the right path? And how much is on the sales point? What's the human factor there for the success? Yeah, so sorry, are you asking, like, so you don't have a discovery call? Do you do just only a demo? Yes, you. So you're trying to find out their pain points while you're showing them the demo? You have sent an email. Okay. They have responded, yes, yes, and it's good for the call.

[01:03:12 - 01:04:00]
You go on the call, you show them the project. Okay, so if you don't want to show them the product first, first you have to ask the questions, right? If you do them together, which is okay, you just have to practice so it's very smooth. You just want to ask them the questions to the end of the day before we show them the product. I absolutely want to show you the product, can't wait to show it to you. I know you're really excited to see these things. I want to understand first what you're trying to tell, so I make sure to show you the right things. We have a lot of functionality. I don't want to waste your time before my time, right, going through and showing all the stuff if you don't care about it. So let me understand what you care about first, right? Okay, you can really push back nicely. Because first you're nice. This thing was functionality, and it was like if you can put it at the right time, in the right space, then that really changes the part. It's not that there is this super like, I don't know, this technical guy in front of you.

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Just show the demo to me, buddy. Like what are all these questions for? This thing, I thought it really helps. I have actually 1,000 features right now. Yeah. But. You're like, what do you want to teach? Yeah. Mm-hmm. Okay. So we're right there. Okay. Mm-hmm. We're going to talk about men. So they need to think that first of all, Hey, here's the agenda for our call. Like, first I'm going to ask a couple of questions to make sure I understand what you're trying to solve, make sure we're aligned, right? And then I'm going to show you the demo based on what you told me. Does that sound good? Great. In this journey, how much of significance has the common factor, the sales in itself? The salesman. In this process, do we need a lot of focus on that?

[01:04:48 - 01:05:32]
Really, it's also a myth in sales. I think in more transactional sales, right, people are usually trying to see if the features fit what they're trying to solve, right? If it solves the problem that they have, and if it's not very expensive, they can buy it and move forward or if they're comparing. What you lose with some of the AI agents or having not a human is that the things that you would think about as a person, which takes practice, but the things you think about as a person when you're like, are you piloting other ones? And the way that you ask it, because you can ask things in a softer way, which is not pushy, What is your budget?

[01:05:33 - 01:06:18]
So like, oh, the alligators that side can make sure this already. Are you already spending money on this? Right? The things that you ask in like a softer human way often give you more answers, right? Then if you have something like an AI agent or something else, right? And so that part is very important for a more complex scale because there's all these intricacies and things that you understand that you're like, if you tell me this thing, I know this means x, right? But if you don't have that or you're missing that, And it's not that the salesperson is the best at selling. The best salespeople are the ones that ask to understand, right? That are consultative. That are like, I'm trying to understand deeply your problem, so I find what's a good fit for you.

[01:06:18 - 01:07:05]
And sometimes it's saying like, you're not a good customer. Sometimes it's saying like, actually you're not a good fit,

we don't sell that problem at all. Like, I tend to be like, here's some other companies that make a good fit. If you're trying to do more of this, we can help you, right? Not . But so there is definitely a human component to it that you lose if you just react . Yeah. Do you have a question? I was just going to respond to whether that might work for the support, meaning that we want to try to have an agent to ask this. I really want to show the product, but answering Yeah, you can try to do it. If they can tell, say, I would be like, no, just show me the product.

[01:07:06 - 01:07:53]
No, I'm not. But if it's a person and they're like, could you just let me know what you think about this and ask it in a nice way? As a person, I am way more likely to answer it because I won't just be like, you know, when you're on the phone and say anything, no, no, no, I'm going to talk to someone. Right? Dude, that's an amazing handle. I mean, it's a demo itself, like, so you can just shift immediately. Like, if there's a human answer, we can go. But everything goes. Yeah. Yeah. Do it. Here are the things that an excuse can answer, right? You just lose part of the, if you are trying to understand, like, if they're doing, like, buy versus build, if they're, like, the main stakeholder, right? Because you are probably not going to ask, are you the main decision maker? because nine times out of ten they're going to tell you yes even if they're not.

[01:07:53 - 01:08:40]
And you're like, oh, okay, absolutely. Like, what does the process look like when you buy things like this? Does it go to someone else internally? Because it usually does go to someone else internally. It's usually not just done buying it, but they're going to tell you that they do it. Right? Maybe I'll go back to it. But yeah, I'm the decision maker. They're not going to be like, but are you really? Like. That's how you frame this. Yes. Yeah. Yeah. How will you decide to move on? I don't know. Right? Yeah. Yeah. And then try with the person and compare and see what works and what works for different industries or markets. Because maybe for fintech product it doesn't work if they ask more things, but maybe for just another beauty marketing product it does. When you decide to fire the customer in the process.

[01:08:41 - 01:09:28]
like sometimes when we go through schools, it's like, like one of the times it's okay, fine, we're not going to move forward so we can't work together. Well, I wouldn't say it like that. How would you do that? Yes, how would you do that? It's kind of a random process, right? If you're like on the discoverer call with them and you're like, we literally cannot do the thing you want us to do, right? If you're like, we do AI agents and you want like someone to like paint your holes in your We're not a person. We can't do this for you. Then you let them know them. You don't do it general because you're literally not trying to solve the problem that we solve our problem. And then later, let's say they come back and do all the more things and they're giving the best prize and then they're in a bad position. It's not a good customer. You should not put your own bad position, but whenever you give people something, you

[01:09:28 - 01:09:59]
should always get something in return. Sometimes it's like, oh, can you put this together, this custom demo for me? Can you just actually do this one thing? We would actually do this We'll buy tomorrow if you build this part, but we really need that part to do it. Right? You should never do things if they just ask for them. Right? If they ask for it, you ask for something back. We can absolutely build that. We need a six month commitment. Oh, Engage are working with us. We'll build it. It'll take us a month. Right? Or if they're like, oh, can you send us over a proposal? Can you send us a debt? How are you doing all those things? Right? And you're like,

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[01:10:00 - 01:10:44]
oh, yeah, absolutely. But let me ask you a question first. Usually when people ask that, they have some more questions around x, y, z. Or usually we bring these other people on board to answer some questions when we do a group strategy session. That's usually what other customers like to do. We could do this, but usually what people do is this other thing. Can we do this other thing? Yeah. Right? It's reframing. You're just reframing the conversation right? Especially very, very early. A lot of times the customer manages you, right? They're like, oh, sorry, I missed the call. Oh, sorry. I missed this one too. Can we actually go on next week on Monday? Can we go on Monday? Stop. Right? It's just yanking me around. And they're like, can you build these other things? If you build these other things, then we'll definitely sell it.

[01:10:45 - 01:11:30]
Right? Now, they're going to ask for the move, right? Because they're moving, especially if you say yes. People say

yes, they're like, cool, what else can I ask for? Right? If you're going to build it for me, fantastic. right but you ask for things back right how can we do another demo call here's what I would like to have on the call to be able to do it so it makes sense for all of us right yeah okay aligning the buying process and selling process this is important not just for you but for all of your new hires right for anyone that you hire whether they're sales people customer success people right because they are often doing themselves you want to be thinking about how you're how you're thinking about them and how you're talking internally about what that looks like, right? So, whether you're documenting it, whether you're drawing it out, right?

[01:11:30 - 01:12:14]
Whether you say here are stages, here's what it looks like to sell to a government with Asta, here's what it looks like to sell the whole business with Asta, right? Like, those are very different when we bring people on board. Everyone should know and everyone internally should know and understand, right? Because they're building for those customers. Even the engineers, right, should understand what the buying process looks like for customers If they don't know and they don't understand, right, they're making judgment calls, they're making decisions that are affecting customers, but you're not communicating with them on what that looks like, right, and what it should be. Yeah? What else makes sales difficult, besides all of the things we just talked about? What else makes sales hard? Besides knowing the stakeholders, knowing internally what's happening, knowing they're buying and selling classes?

[01:12:17 - 01:13:04]
How long? Maybe that's a look. How long? Maybe this is a different question. So I'm really trying to understand how I best understand their pain points. Because I think it's a little different to the space where we are. And we see . We have joined by their employers. But I'm just trying to thus evaluate the pain so I can really understand what it's like. So we're doing discovery calls. And so I think that will help with like, I'll have a list of questions. And I think choosing what some of them to understand will be more helpful. And then also the discovery questions to see where they are to see if they even know they have a problem that they won't solve. Right? Like where they're in the market. Because I think that'll determine a lot for you of like if they don't feel like they have a problem, you can't help them.

[01:13:05 - 01:13:49]
Right? Or you have to do a lot of work whether it's like webinars and content and education around like here's why the insurance space needs to do more with like wearables for all of the properties. What I'm going to say here is technology adoption. That is really hard, right? Let's see, how long did it take, right? This is showing you like different things like the telephone, washing machine, air conditioning, even a personal computer. How many years it took to reach 60% of US households? It took 29 years for a laptop to reach 60%. That's crazy, right?

[01:13:50 - 01:14:35]
That's a long time. And so when you're thinking about who's adopting technology, who's adopting things, right? About who in this space, especially with like corporates and governments are much slower. They're much slower to adopt. They're much more nervous to adopt things. Versus if you're selling to a server who's like, yeah, I tried all the things. I'm going to have to stay forever, but I'll try them all and see what happens. Right? And so when we're thinking about who they are and where they are, you're thinking about Like the ICPs that you're thinking about, the personas that you're thinking about, where do they fall in technology adoption? Right? Where are they? Are they very excited like I have to try this first. I want to be ahead of everyone else. I want to know more than everyone else in the market does that try all the things. Are they visionaries? Are they more like, oh, this is really cool. They talk about it.

[01:14:35 - 01:15:25]
They're some of the first people to use something. They're like sharing with their colleagues. They're maybe going on webinars or on podcasts. They're talking about new things they're using. Are they pregnant? Are they saying like why should I start using this? Are you talking to some companies, some industries that are like why is this valuable for you? Tell me why this is important. They're not the I'm really excited not me saying no I'm traveling and stuff. They're like I need to understand why. I need some social proof. I need to know and understand what value this brings to me. I need to see other people using it successfully. I need to see some outcomes. Some conservative people are later. They're like I should have done this sooner but I'm just going to wait. I'm not excited. That's definitely where a lot of like government and enterprises fall, right? Teams within enterprises might fall more right on the visionary and busy side, right?

[01:15:25 - 01:16:10]
And you'll have teams that if you can get in and start working with them and then you can expand across the board, that's much better. Or as a whole are more conservative, right? So we're thinking about like the types of conversations

you're having with customers, the things that they're saying, the ICPs you're testing out, the markets you're testing out. new IPB, when you're trying to market, see who you're talking to, the kind of response you're getting, right? Are they excited about trying new things? Are they trying lots of other things? Or are they like, oh, can I see a bunch of case studies? Do you have my exact industry case study? Do you have someone that I can talk to as a reference? Do you have all these other things, right? And you're like, okay, you need a lot more social proof, which is okay, but that's going to be a much longer sales cycle for you, right? Because they're not as excited to go start eating something. Yeah.

[01:16:11 - 01:16:56]
Okay. We're thinking about, who's heard the term beachhead market before? Okay, I was like, someone has to. Okay, you guys. Okay, so we're thinking about, right, this like adoption curve of where people are, and this like, right, your early ones are your like smaller markets, like the people that are like excited about technology, willing to try new things, that's usually your very first customer, right? And then when we're trying to go over to this bigger group, right, this bigger section of our, majority, people that are excited, we're thinking about, we're crossing the chasm to the majority of people, and our beachhead market, we're thinking about what do all these people have in common, right? How can we get our first access point into this larger market, and how do they align, right? And so we're thinking about this market, right? We're thinking about

[01:16:56 - 01:17:42]
how are they similar, right? How are they aligned? They buy products the same way, right? They either buy them, right? They like see people on podcasts, they go to the same conferences, They go to the same things, right? If you talk to a VP of marketing at any company in SF, they have all tried all the same products, right? Because they talk about them to each other all the time. No one will stay left behind. Everyone has the same FQLS, QO goals, right? That they're trying to hit. They all are very, very, very front and forward of like finding new technology. So the word of mouth communication is really important in a VTN market, right? People who reference you to other people, right? If it's a market in a space where people are very competitive and they don't talk to other people and don't share things, that's on a mutual market, right? You want a market where people are sharing and talking to each other and being engaged with each other, right?

[01:17:42 - 01:18:30]
You want them to have a budget that exists, right? If you are going somewhere and they have to get a budget from somewhere else, they don't have a budget, right? Like, let's say you're selling to an engineering team, like, they have budget rituals, right? It is there. It is accessing budget. If you're selling to someone like a partnerships team their budget set of like very specific things that are going to you, to events, to different things, and they have to create a budget for you, that's much harder. And you have to pull a budget from somewhere, get budget from somewhere else. That's a much harder sale than like, we have this budget to apply to a bunch of things and just deciding where to put it. So your B2M market is like they have a budget to solve a bunch of problems, and you are taking from that budget. Not like, we need to find out where in the company

[01:18:30 - 01:19:15]
we could potentially pull this budget from. compelling need right they have a problem they have a problem that you can solve it's not a nice to have it's not a oh this could be helpful maybe it's a we have this problem and we want to solve it right that's what we're looking for in a reach the market limited competition direct access direct access meaning um there are people that you can connect with in some way right let's say you are selling to china and you're like okay you're not on linkedin you're not on places it's harder for us to access like where can you access them can you access them If you can't access them, if they're an older industry, they're not on LinkedIn, they don't have phone numbers, they don't have anything else, that's not your beachhead market. That can be a market you go after, but that's not your beachhead market because you can't access them.

[01:19:16 - 01:19:59]
You don't find them places, you can't see them, you can't target them in any way. They're like maybe a market that you can maybe come across in some way, but not your beachhead market to the larger group. Yes, fast decision making, right? Three month cycle max, because it's not your beach and market if you can't access and get them and expand them, right? That's one of our beach head market. Willing to try new solutions and clear success metrics so you can show ROI, right? It's very, very hard to go after a beach and market if you can't show results, right? Because they talk to each other, they talk about things that are different, that have changed, what the results look like. You have to have results and you have to be able to show them. So you say, someone just like you, you did this thing,

here's the results they got from it. Right? You have to be able to do that for a vision worker.

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Yes? Questions about that? Yeah? I would say for those early golfers and innovators, for that means the sales cost even shorter. So they make the fastest decisions. Yeah, so they're willing to try more things. They might not stay forever, but they're willing to try more things. For example, for us, they're getting the fastest pilots, the fastest distribution. Yeah, it would be people that are willing to do your things. Those are the people that are willing to do your things. So, yeah, yeah, like innovation department, you have budget to try to throw out things, right? Because they're like, that's their job. Innovation departments? That's like innovation departments? Yep. They have certain budgets? Yep. Just for testing and trying things, right? And then the budget will go to someone else, whoever owns it, whatever area you're fixing,

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but their budget is specifically to try these things, especially enterprises, right? They often have an innovation team. Now there's also AI teams that are pitched a thousand times a day.

[01:21:05 - 01:21:53]
So, you were doing personas with Justina a little bit and I want to just talk about the difference between one ICP is and a persona and what I want you to think about when you're talking about ICPs and markets that you're going after. So, your persona helps you target between different types of people. What they like, what they do in the morning, all of those things, and you know all of them. Your ICP is much more structural. I want you thinking about your industry demographic. I want you thinking about geography. I want you thinking about the size of the company, the salary of the person, the need in the pain point that they have, any decision-making factors, the way that they consume media, the way they access things, and any custom data points. And custom data points are things that will tell you something about the company, like

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is a proxy for a company. So when we're thinking about what our ICP is, right? When we're thinking about specific verticals in industry, the company size, I want you to be so specific. Is it 50 to 500 employees? Is it the amount of error that they're at? Is it the employee count? We're thinking about geography. Is it like large cities in North America? Is it cities over a million people in Europe? I want you thinking about how targeted can you be for where customers are and where you're looking for them. It could be tools they already use. If you're like, hey, if you already use Slack, you could use our tool. If you already use an applicant tracking system, then you could use our website for finding managers.

[01:22:40 - 01:23:27]
If you're already spending money on something, it's easier. If they're not spending money, if they don't have a contracting system, if they're not already investing in recruiting, it's much harder to get a budget than it is for someone who's shown that they already are willing to spend a million on it. So when you're thinking about what that looks like, are there any proxies? Are there any things that would show you, okay, they're already spending money in this area, right? And so we can use that because you'll be a better customer for us because I can kind of already know you will have a budget because you have a budget. Yeah. I'm thinking about like the use case and how they're using it. Right. And so your ICP might have the use case of here's why they're going to use this for us. Right. Of here's what they care about. Here's what we're going to solve for them. It might be buying behavior, how they make purchase decisions. And it might be like their budget, like how much they'll spend.

[01:23:28 - 01:24:16]
Right. Because if you know other softwares that they bought, we know how much money they send on software. Right. Most softwares you can see how much people are spending and how much they cost. So if you have Salesforce, you are already spending a lot of money, right? How many employees that you have, right? And are you paying? So it's a thousand dollars a year, right, for employees. So you're already spending, I already have an approximate amount, I know how much you're spending, right? To give you like some anchor, like some context or price. So we're thinking about ICPs, right? Let's say I'm selling an applicant tracking system and I want to sell to finance. Finance companies in major cities, I want to go after San Francisco, Chicago, New York, I'm looking after are VP, people, head of people, head of HR, and the custom data I care about

[01:24:16 - 01:25:02]
is the last sort of review rating because if they have, do you know what the last sort is? Okay. It's like an employee review company, so I can give them a rating. And so if you have a higher rating, the employers are happier there, right? And so I'm like, I think if people invest more and people are happier at companies, then they're going to spend more on their recruiting and on the people side of things because they've shown that they care and do more for their employees. And that would be like an ICP that you would say, this is what I'm going to test because I think this is a proxy for me that they will send on this and that they care about this. If they have a low GLAPSOR score, that means they don't care about it, so they're not putting money into recruiting or into the people side of things because they don't really care. Where can we get the information that they use these kind of specific tools?

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So, Glassdoor is just publicly available so you can just look. It's just like a website. Yeah, it's a website. But you still play Buildit? Buildit? No, we don't have to play. We use Play. Play has a . Yeah. On your case, you just use the . Okay, I mean, you can use anything, right? Some people will use like either through play or play is expensive so sometimes people just use it with and pull from there and say like I want all people that are using like leather like an African tracking system I want everyone doing that because I think people that pay for this will pay for something else so you can do something like that right to find some of those it could be something like there's a solar company that like wanted the square footage of buildings because

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Because they're like, you have to be between a certain size of a rooftop for us to put some of them there. So we have to find that. And you can find it, right? You can go get it. But it's just like a custom data point. And like, why would we waste time talking to people who are either like too big or like too small and don't fit, right? So when you're thinking about your ICP and your customers and what they care about and what they're spending and the problems that they're solving for the size that they're at, what are some custom things that would be relevant for you that you could try, right? It might be you try a couple ICPs or you interview and ask some of your customers some more things to find out things that they have in common. Like you might find out that everyone uses some random marketing tool. And you're like, oh, okay, so everyone who uses this newer marketing tool would also use us because they're like buying a bunch of new things to be innovated in the market.

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Right? But you're like, okay, then they'll buy us too because they're a good fit, right? Because they're trying and testing different things. But like you guys know your markets best, right? So here are some customers we have in common. We can think about the things that they have that might be some custom data points that might be some specific ICPs. But being very, very specific on your ICP and trying to find some proxies, right, or information that is more than just this company size, this location, this place, right? Because your messaging is not going to be very targeted, right? If I target all of the people that are just finance, major cities, company size with this title, more that I would have, but my messaging and writing things that I'm thinking that they

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care about are not going to be the same, right? I'd rather you send, and we'll talk about this tomorrow, I'd rather you send much, much fewer messages that are highly targeted and very specific and speak to the person than not send 10,000 emails, right? It means nothing to me if you're like, you sent 10,000 emails today. I do not care, right? How many of them responded to you? Okay, you automated and sent a bunch of emails, right? What does that help you do? forward and do like not very much right if you're like hey i sent 25 really really targeted emails like super specific and i got two people to respond great if you said i said 10 000 emails and two or five like that's kind of terrible right you're just gonna ruin your domain yeah um we'll talk about the more fun okay so icps here are like very specific i have three examples

[01:28:16 - 01:29:02]
that um that you guys can look at a reference um later because this is how specific i want you to I want you to be thinking about, okay, I'm looking at mid-market B2B SaaS companies in the U.S. and Canada. I want to look at companies that use sales stores. HubSpot have 10 open sales roles or SDR roles because I think that means they're hiring a lot. They're trying. They're not only hiring a lot, have budget for that, but probably also have a budget for other things if you have a lot of roles open, right? Maybe they've recently hired a VP of sales or robots leader, right? because that could be a trigger for me that when a new revenue leader comes in they have 90 days to make some impact and make some changes right for 90 days they can basically buy or do whatever they want before people start

being like what's happening with our numbers what are you doing so

[01:29:02 - 01:29:48]
they try to do as much as they can in the first nine days right so that's a really good time to target people um funding although funding is hit or miss right because if you announce that you have a funding round everyone messages you it's like now you have money you want my product so about the pain point that you're solving, right? Not just, saw you raise a series B, do you want to buy my product? No, right? These are gonna get 10 million emails like that. Um, such a two profile with like 20 plus reviews because people are reviewing them, maybe they care about that more, right? You're thinking about that. Thinking about trigger events, um, again, the hiring, new ops, appearing at conferences, right? If they're appearing at conferences like, okay, you're at least spending, you're hearing conferences, you're sponsoring them, you're spending 10 to 20k per event to the conference I know you're at least sending that option on thing right?

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Yeah at least all these things seem very very credible to what you do and to be honest I tried the majority

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of those already and none of those overcome. But did you try with messaging that we went over on? Yeah, obviously I tried it related to this proxy we are talking about. So yeah, I tried to tie the message to the problem that might be associated with them hiring 10SDR for example. I mean back then, I was going to have zero results. I'm having a hard time to come up with new forms. Because these might seem very obvious to what we do. And how we do sales, tiring, SDRs, using some tools.

[01:30:46 - 01:31:35]
That's what I'm planting. We can talk more interesting. Tomorrow we'll talk about outreach. I know some of you are excellent in outreach. We'll talk about outreach tomorrow. I don't know how many you're sending. We haven't talked about that yet. Each proxy is obviously shrinking your time and you cannot send like a thousand if you have a hundred or even less that might break you. Yeah, there definitely are. So when we're thinking about our ICPs and thinking about messaging, someone before they buy needs to see you six or seven times. And so if you send two or three emails, that's basically two or three times, right?

[01:31:35 - 01:32:20]
Maybe not even two or three times, right? So tomorrow we'll talk about like a multi-channel approach because now you can't just send an email. You can't just send an email. I forgot to mention that I used LinkedIn and email. Yeah, yeah, yeah. And things, but also like right now cold calling is becoming more popular, on social media is more popular, right? connecting with people into a conference and like interacting and providing some value is very common. Like there's a lot more things to do than just like sending some emails with just messaging. You now have to be more, right? You have to offer some additional value besides just sending a message. So we'll talk about like examples tomorrow. Like one of the ones I think I mentioned to you guys from a company last batch. They bring product also.

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And what they did is, this is what a lot of people would like to do, I think we talked about it already, is reaching out to people and doing an ebook for product leaders, you could do for marketing leaders, right? About like this, this, and this. We have these logos already talking to us. We'd love to talk to you as well. And that has been an excellent lead generation channel for them. Excellent. Because people want to talk to them. They're like, could you just give us a look on our product, right? And then they can bring their product and then some of them use it, half of them use it I think after these interviews. And so, do the toy course. What? The toy course. Did they try hard? Yeah, do the toy course. Oh, true course, yes. Yes, yes, yes. Yes, yes. So, right, you can do something like that, right? But there's a lot more things that you can do in providing value, right? Another company from a previous match, I have an example, there's tomorrow, they do software for airlines, right?

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not great until we changed it, right? But then they offered like some data points, some data that the airlines do not have, and now all of the airlines want to talk to them, right? Because they're like, you have some interesting data that we don't have. We'd all love to talk to you, right? And everyone responds to their messages. So sometimes it's about

the content, right? Sometimes it's about like how you're approaching them. Sometimes it's about reaching them in different ways. And there's a lot of things that you can do when we talk about outreach, but it's never just like we already tried and sent these to the ICPs with a message. Like there's always more things that you can try to do, right? Okay, great. But we can brainstorm more office hours also. I'm happy to talk about more proxies. So I have a bunch of examples of ICPs to just get you thinking about what proxies you could use or what you could have, right? If it's, if I'm selling to multi-location healthcare clinics, right?

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They have 10 to 200 locations or 100 to 2,000 employees. I want to know how many locations they have listed. I don't know if they're private equity backed or recently acquired. If they're hiring practice managers, right? They're hiring practice managers because they need more admins, because they have more like management things that they're trying to do that they're like falling behind in. If they're expanding into new cities, If they're using a known EHR system, right, then job postings a lot of times if you're hiring a nurse, you're hiring a CD, or saying like are you familiar with the CHR that we already use because this is the one we're using. And so job postings will often give you a lot of information about the company, right, about things that you're expected to do, things that they do internally, or things that they want you to already know, right, and so you can pull a lot of interesting information from there.

[01:34:51 - 01:35:35]
But so there's different things you could look at here, right, for healthcare. right okay we're looking at a law firm and we're looking at different practice areas we're looking at hiring for different roles legal tech or document systems that they're looking at recent partner hires mergers right because all of these anytime there's a trigger event I call the trigger event or something that happens it gives you an opportunity for change right when there's an opportunity for change there's a time that you can come in and do something different right that is a nice opening because of their new hires there's new people there's a lot of new hiring they're already pruned and ready to make some changes in the organization. Does that make sense? And then examples. And this trigger, you will be typically able to find anywhere, like signals and anything.

[01:35:36 - 01:36:21]
Yeah, yeah. And that's what would be their hiring. Hold up, even LinkedIn streaming was like they're hiring like this is what they're projected to hire because they've been hiring a lot or like their teams have been pretty flat or like sales has increased by 10% over the past quarter. So you can do things like that. So some where you can be like, I think this is maybe an interesting data point for us. Let's try and see and talk to more of them and see if it does help us or if it's not nice again. We'll try another one. OK? And those are some examples for you to look at. So good custom data points for you. I know you guys already are thinking about them. Who else is thinking about some data points? Who else is using some custom data points right now? What are you using? Not bad signals.

[01:36:22 - 01:37:07]
like number or type or? Just the fact that the particular ICP is hiring for all. It sounds like it's a role in cliche but it's just a role. Okay, great. Now in case of this is a product launch, sales growth. and some posts from ICP about the strategy of the management responsible for the first time. Oh, great. OK, perfect. What else? Anyone else? Anyone thinking about some now? That could be? Yeah, you still have some.

[01:37:08 - 01:37:52]
Yeah. It's kind of more sales process, depositions. New market. New market. New market. New market. Yeah. New market opening. New market opening. New market opening. Could be also like new bars or restaurant openings, right? And then second location or like a studio opening, like a quality studio or a bar. like if they're opening a location they also need frontline workers right like usually at least by me i always see them months in advance they're like okay there's no location here um which is also maybe an interesting interview anyone else what about yeah yeah we try both these things like uh

[01:37:54 - 01:38:43]
wordpress okay and it's dying now i'm going to be informed that the purpose is dying Everyone is using phones. What's the good about that? Our challenge really is to have a soft, B2B, all of the challenges for the B2B working role, for the industry, B2B SaaS. Is it really an industry? Because B2B SaaS solves everything. What's your feeling of that? Because I'm thinking it's like... No, you should take a sub-internative. You know what I mean? But even, right, it might be something that doesn't scale now, but something that you could think about, right? um uh when i worked with google something that they wanted that they had actual people do was they would go look at websites for their like new new business they wanted um for their cloud

[01:38:43 - 01:39:30]
uh business they wanted to look at websites and they had a specific list of things they want to see so does it look like a 90s website does it have an email that doesn't pop out does it have like these specific colors like they're like this is our target ic key of who we want to get and we want to pay someone to go through to identify because this is exactly if they have a website like this this is exactly our target and we're going to do this what people would want so like what are things that you will learn about your customers or maybe you could ask or find out about that is like very random not scalable thing but for right now you can definitely do it right to identify and find out like you are a good customer and it's this very random thing like that you have like maybe they have like a contact us instead of um like booking directly at an counter. Maybe it's like a very random thing that you're like, this makes no sense, but

[01:39:30 - 01:39:59]
everyone that has this thing actually thinks we're great for them. So we're going to find more of them like this, right? Things that don't make sense, that are not just like your typical job listings or things that are opening. Like what else do your customers have in common? Your best customers, the customers you have now, what do they have in common? What do they do? Where do they spend their time? That you can say like, okay, everyone that goes to this conference their company is our customer right maybe it's a random conversation we know another thing is um uh

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[01:40:00 - 01:40:46]
leader. So there's a thought leader in finance and whoever. And then we get the news and we let them know, hey, it's just a little bit of this. That's what we're relying on as well. Like speaking about things? Yes, all of those things. Many, many things. OK, so I want you to make a list of five to seven potential ICPs, right, with different data points. And I want you to map them. I think some of you have already talked about doing this. I want you to plot them on here with our, what access is pain level, how much of a pain do they have? Right? The problem that you're solving, how painful is this problem for them? Is it a lot? Is it the middle? Is it a little? Do you not know? You should find out if you don't know. Right? But clock, the ICP, where is it? And then ease of reach. How easy is it for you to reach them? How hard is it for you to reach them? Right? And we, as well as up to the right, those are the people that we want to go for first.

[01:40:46 - 01:41:30]
Right? The ICPs that we want to target. The people that are, have the biggest problem they want to solve and the easiest for us to access and reach. Yeah? That's true. A question. Yeah. Well, this is your pitch. Am I right that the bigger company, the harder to reach their CX level of the B's? Well, it depends on what you're doing, right? It depends on how you reach them. Generally, yes. But maybe you're like, hey, maybe you have a concern. The result is like, hey, I'm a student at this university, and I'm researching these things. So I talked to you for 15 minutes and interview you. Also depends on your region. I'm told to do this, unfortunately. Totally. Someone else. There's someone else on your team.

[01:41:32 - 01:42:22]
But it depends on your area too, right? In the Bay Area, a lot more people are willing to respond or be friendly. They're like, hey, I'm here for two weeks. Like, I would love to chat. I admire that you did an X, Y, and Z. I would love to meet. People are like pretty open to meeting. But other areas, not so much, right? People don't. So yes, generally they're harder to reach, but if it's a huge problem that they have, they may forward they email to someone else and say, hey, do you want to talk to them about this? Like, we just talked about this last week in our meeting. They might not talk to you, but they might forward it internally, right? Mm-hmm. And so in thinking about what they care about and the type of messaging you give, right? So here, also as an example, right? we'll talk about messaging again tomorrow but um when you're targeting people and talking about

[01:42:22 - 01:43:12]
the problems if you target a cro or a vp of sales at a large company and they have like 50 sales people and you say are your demos not converting they're not going to respond to you that is not their level right not at all that would not respond right but if you're talking about like hitting their targets or you do something of helping them like hit for their quarter or team's performance or you help increase something else right that like they care about everyone talks the same no everyone like about hitting the targets well i don't know but how you do it right well we're going to talk about value props in a minute or maybe about the lunch and i don't remember the ceiling but like very specifically about like the toggles that you're solving for them right and

[01:43:12 - 01:44:01]
how you solve them is really important but if you're going like too high right those people at a learner company those people do not care because your problems are very operational that you're solving right and so then you need to target and talk to the people whose job is solving the operational problems right because they care right and they want to solve it and they're going to like break it up to solve their problems right um because again if you're if your messaging is targeted towards the wrong type of person they are not going to respond it doesn't matter what your about something that they functionally don't care about or are responsible for, they're not going to respond. Yeah? um save a few icps of how are we feeling so it's 11 30. i know it's been 90 minutes you want to stand up for a second and wiggle around a little and then we'll finish a little bit and i think

[01:44:01 - 01:44:46]
we'll do more after the lunch while i'm on the floor yeah okay so shake for five minutes run to the bathroom go up like in the mirror walk back in i know 90 minutes is a long time to like sit in one place i mean i'm standing you can all stand too five minutes five minutes come back and i'll and then we'll do these. Water, peanut banana. How are you? It was good. Good. Yeah, it was perfect. Ah, really? I look at you every time. Everything. Because it's not much cheaper. Much cheaper. I need to say, here. Yeah.

[01:44:46 - 01:45:32]
Because in San Francisco it's like a double price. Oh, okay. I think you can hear it. Oh, nice. Was it okay? It was good, it was good. On Saturday, the bar just under our apartment, they had a party until 6.30 am. It's a very loud music. Really? Yeah, yeah, yeah. We are three businesses at all. Yeah. Yeah, it was really exciting for us. What street are you on? Sure. Are you on the street? Or what street are you on? You didn't get it.

[01:45:32 - 01:46:21]
Street? Yeah, it's like Park Street. They are most probably favorite food. The large food here. It's very close to this. It's very loud. I even called the A's. Really? Yeah. They called me. Nothing. It's crazy. Yeah. I went to pharmacy at like 1.30 to grab some ear implants. Did they help? Yeah, it was great. It was a great thing. Everything was great.

[01:46:21 - 01:47:06]
Yeah, it's not possible in areas. Like this kind of, you know, just living here, you can open a bar so you can play the music as long as a whole lot. I mean, it is possible. Really? Yes, there are a lot of things. You'll probably have a legal level with the city and yourself for the business. Because it has to be zoned properly. Like there was an interest that happened where it was a huge catapulting. But if it's zoned correctly, there's not really much you can do about it. There's no ways, time drop or anything.

[01:47:06 - 01:47:40]
There aren't like rural, like the top. Like there's a no idea. yeah and if it's done correctly okay you can find other dummies so like don't pick the bar because I was really sure inside this is not really yeah yeah you can go to the police up there 10pm or 11pm and yeah yeah here's one it's a problem

[01:47:52 - 01:48:37]
Here? Yeah. So I was like, I think this sounds like this one time from the door, but like, hold them, they don't want to do this, it doesn't mean I'm not going to do it. Yeah. Let me do it. Let me do it. Yeah. Thanks. So we are not friends. Yeah. And every night, every night the police comes to our street, So now you can raise a lot of time. There's a lot of music from Sunday morning. I'm quite quiet.

[01:48:38 - 01:49:23]
I'm praying to do that on the night. But there's still a lot of time going to silence. Yeah. Don't care. It's not enough like a noise. I guess I had to do this. Yeah. So maybe a little more. Yeah. Perfect. Just so I can not forget how to do a bunch of conditions. So good. Okay, guys, we're ready to come back. We just have a little bit more, and we'll do value propositions after lunch, I think. We'll just finish up the leave-in and buy-in. And then, just a couple more things to follow the list. to close the loop on this, right? Building a list, right?

[01:49:23 - 01:49:59]
Like, contacts are very cheap. You can buy a list of 5,000, 20,000, 100,000, right? You can buy a list, you can buy a list, and then you can put some contacts that are probably a little bit out of date, are not the best fit, are just like a list of chaos, right? Don't buy a chaos list, right? Lists are not for real, right? We, people who are genuinely interested, who have some sort of proxy, some sort of figure, some sort of identification that show that they would be a good fit for you, right, are the ones you want. We don't have them.

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If you're like, yay, I just downloaded the list of 100,000 people, like, I literally do not care. Are they a good fit for you? Are 200 of them a good fit for you? Then I care, right? Then I want to talk about that. So I want to make sure when you're thinking about things, when you're thinking about your metrics, your KPIs, or if you hire someone on your team, right? If you hire someone to do outreach, and they're like, I reached out to 5,000 people today. Who did you reach out to? Were they the ICP? Did they have anything, like, relevant or interesting? just reach out to 5,000 people, right? We don't want that. Quality versus quantity, right? And I just, I want you to be thinking about like the quality of the leads of the people that you have because the conversion is better, lifetime value is better, your customer acquisition accounts is better, all the things are better. In terms of some tools, this is one that people love to show. There's so many tools you can use. There's probably a thousand more every day of different things that people are building, especially with AI of like sales tools you can use, right?

[01:50:57 - 01:51:42]
um so many to use like for your initial lists right like thinking about again the proxies and where you can get um information that may be the proxy information to start for your initial ones because we want to be very targeted right we don't want to go follow and download lists of like thousands of thousands of people that is thousands are not our customers that is just random people on the internet that have an email that we can see right those are not our people so we're thinking about like built with um orange slice cognizant like we want to use a larger database to filter and think about our spds and think about specific targets that we want to go after and then we want to try to access them yes um you can also write like sometimes people will hire you can hire someone on upwork um a freelancer somewhere for like three or four dollars an hour to go through and be like

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i need you to look at like their website right like google it i need you to look at all their websites and I need you to mark whether they have like this thing or not right start to do the same things they're like we want to know they're real company these five things mean that they're real companies need something to go through and check these things right or you can build an agent a lot of you are checking them you don't have to say like yeah yeah to go through and like check someone's data right you can definitely do that as well um more places um that you can look at like webinar registrants right if you build your own lead channel with webinars or you partner with people um you can partner with someone who has a similar customer base to the world market as you not the same product right not your competitors you could but like with someone who has the same market as you and you do webinars together to start building your own lead funnel and channels so you are an expert in something in some field

[01:52:31 - 01:53:19]
you all are very chatty so i know you can definitely do it right with not that much lift to have a webinar have some sort of series where you're talking about something talking about teaching people about something to start like driving more of your traffic right um company news podcast guest lists um linkedin groups in different communities um or competitive customer stories right some people do that if you're like i know that every person that uses this competitor hates this thing i know that companies in the fintech space that use this person hate this product because of that you'd be like hey we solved this very specific problem that i know you have with a competitor because everyone has this problem but we know differently because this right Before a company goes on your list, right? Before you message them, before you do anything with them, do this in your ICP.

[01:53:19 - 01:54:12]
Do this in an ICP that you have? Is there like a pain point? Right? Do they have a problem? Do I think there's a problem? Is there a trigger event? Can I identify the right buyer? Or is it a new market and do I not know the buyer? And so I kind of need to go and figure out, I need to do interviews, I need to navigate, I need to ask someone who has a space, like who the real buyer would be. And then do I have a credible reason to reach out now? Not, saw you as series B, no. At series B, what things happen? Are they hiring a week of sales? Because usually people will write at series B, they're like, now I need sales leaders, I can go from B to C. It's a different person than from A to B. Are they like, is the CEO thinking about hiring a new person? That would be a good time for a recruiting tool, right? Because you're like, you need a very specific person to go from that stage. What other things can you reach out for that are going to help the person at the right time that are some sort of event, some sort of thing because they need to solve that problem now.

[01:54:14 - 01:55:00]
Best practices, potential customers, good content. I don't know if you guys are creating a lot of content. I think you talked about that before last week with Justina. But like relevant, interesting content that you can use for your sales as sales collateral. right because if you're not creating sales content for your sales collateral the sales people that you hire will create either and you will not like it okay it's going to be they're going to make things up they're going to put random things in the sales content that they're going to send to customers and you're going to be like what is that how did you put that there so when we're thinking about the content that we have and we'll talk about some content tomorrow um thinking about what that looks like right your goal throughout all your steps throughout the sales process is to get them to take the next out with you right if you get them on the first call you want to get on the next call you want to get the next stakeholder you want to get someone else involved you want to get a demo next you want to get

[01:55:00 - 01:55:47]
confirmation proposal right you want a next step always every time you talk to a customer you should one learn something new and two move them on to the next step right you should never be ending any calls or conversations or anything with like great okay we're not internally and we'll follow later okay we'll follow up next week about scheduling a call no we want to do it on our call right for next steps um stakeholders i'm going to talk about okay it's 11 42 how are we feeling and with that for a while i have stakeholders and i have customer value proposition still do we want to do that after lunch or do we want to do stakeholders now because i know people are a little distracted we have some computers we have some phones poking around okay okay then

[01:55:47 - 01:56:33]
attention again everyone no both computers pay attention to your stakeholders thank you okay what is what is the stakeholder how many stakeholders what's the stakeholder some somebody on the buying process will influence the buying process full influence yep sometimes they influence sometimes they order they are an actual decision maker they're not always decision makers right but we're thinking and mapping out like how to identify what an org looks like or what the company looks like especially for enterprise or companies government any alarm right or mapping out what those looks like even smaller companies right to understand where people are where they sit what their priorities are and who owns what right or mapping out at first if you start actually writing them out and putting them

[01:56:33 - 01:57:22]
somewhere so you can see them so you can talk about it with your team because there's usually like a space where like someone is here and i don't know who that person is but they mentioned having a partner on the working side and I mentioned having someone here and needed to find out who that is right we're mapping out what they look like and we're mapping them out because there's a few different types of stakeholders um who's thought about like types of stakeholders before in this way economic technical okay great um so I want you to think of stakeholders in four buckets so our economic buyer our technical buyer our influencer and our coach and so our economic buyer is one who has a budget right they're the one who's like your final decision maker who's deciding whether they're going to buy or not um thinking about what that looks like um and making the rental decision right our technical buyer our technical buyer is the one who's looking at

[01:57:22 - 01:58:09]
does this have the features and the functionality that i needed to have does this meet can we integrate with this can we put this in our systems can we include this in a functional way that makes sense right and oftentimes founders get stuck in a technical buyer because they're often the ones that want to talk to you and they want to talk to you for a long time and they're like can you show us this how does this work can you connect with this what does this look like i'm interested in this like functionality i'm interested in this i'm interested in this they make no decisions they're just going through like if you build this other thing then where's your product but we really need these two other things to be able to move forward because it's like really important for us right and it's really easy to get stuck with them oftentimes they don't actually need that thing that they want to be built it's just remember we talked about like companies build little super

[01:58:09 - 01:58:54]
requirements or things that they think they need because a bunch of stakeholders a bunch of people have said like here's what we need here's what we're looking for right and they're going out and this technical buyer is like here's our list of things that i need to check off to make sure we have right and if you don't check off the things they dismiss you unless you understand why they And you sometimes have to bring the other stakeholder that wanted that thing back in, right? Or it's something that you can either do a proxy thing to still make it work. You could still get the value. You

can still solve the problem that they have without that feature functionality, right? But it's very, very easy to get stuck with this technical person because they'll be like, we can't use this unless you have this functionality. But you're like, well, what is your problem, right, that you're trying to solve?

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And can we solve that problem without this functionality? Can you still do some of the things? in this like maybe a manual process on our side that we can help you get your results you want and it's on our roadmap for the next six months right um so i want you to think about that when you're talking to someone like is this the person that has a budget or is this a technical person who's going to distract me and get over here and want me to do a bunch of demos and show me all the things because they want to know exactly how everything works right i think about the influencer right is someone who has an opinion who either has like some requests or things they want who might be working with it within the organization maybe they are the end user right so a lot of times your buyer is not the person that's using it maybe there's someone within the organization that has to integrate it that has to use it if they're like we use Salesforce and all the data has to go to Salesforce um maybe there's someone who just like has an opinion because they used to

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work uh in the department that you're in and they're like these are actually what we need to have and things that are right and so when you're identifying with people that you're talking to again thinking about who else might be influencing the decision and what else they might be saying and if they should be brought in right during your demo

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or during the process. And then coach. Coach is your best, best, best person. Who thinks that they've had a coach recently? Like someone within an organization. Who knows what a coach is? A champion. Yeah, like a champion. Someone who's excited. Sometimes they have nothing to do with the buying process at all. They're just like maybe more on the visionary side of like people that are early adopters and they're like, we love new tools, we love new organization no buying power not tracking them features of functionality but I'm really excited about it and I really want to help you do it right these people are so bad and helpful because they can help you about the orders they can tell you about internal priorities right because then they're nice and they want to be helpful to you if you're like I'm trying to understand like I'd

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love to have you guys as a customer this quarter but like I don't understand internally like how you buy things or like where did where things get stuck who else do I need to talk to is there someone in marketing that's like in these meetings right you can ask them a lot of questions that you can't ask the other ones because they're not going to tell you right you're not going to tell you about this let me ask you a question we have one prospect is like very huge company and for example we'll be of innovation and head of the sales they are like they are our champions there but their VP of sales and VP of marketing they are quite I don't know maybe skeptical maybe they have a lot of things to do else besides like our

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our thing and we don't understand how to reach them how to influence them because they are are decision makers in this process. And yeah, what can we do using these stakeholders that they're on our side? To access, do you have a coach usually, or an influencer or someone, right? And asking about priorities, because everyone has their priorities for the month or the quarter, the things that they're trying to do, right? And they're not always revenue. Like, it is always revenue, but there's always more things besides revenue, right, they're like we have some sales people that are not like in the quota so we need to like pick up for it in some way or do something else to hit my numbers because like there's just I hire someone they're not going to be able to ramp up in three months to hit the

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quota that we have for the quarter right maybe it's like some other internal things where like marketing's not sending them enough MQLs which always happens it's probably always a problem where they're like MQLs are horrible like we can't convert anything right so what there are some things that they would care about, that they would be interested in, that you can ask them about, to see what they're interested in. You can ask them if they're going to be speaking at any conferences, you can ask them if they're going to be around, like if you're going in certain areas.

People at the VP and C level like care about access to other people. They want to know what other people are doing, and they want to be involved in conversations, and they want to be around. So doing something with that is always something you can do because people want to be around other people that are at their home, that they don't already know or have access to.

[02:03:13 - 02:03:58]
So that's something interesting that you could like find out or do or find out like, what other conferences they go to in terms of like what other people will be there. So either you could be there, or you could like talk about something that's happening there. But you are using like the coaches, the influencers, even the checking roboters, say like, what are the priorities for the quarter? Right? Is it that like maybe they're building their own things internally, they're launching some new functionality that you can align with, right? Like when you launch this new thing, you can also have these demos So it's like understanding and turn a little bit about what their goals are. That's why we should do some work. Because there's always things happening in a company. It's never just like trying to hit our goal for the month, for the quarter. It's always like, and then these people left. And then we have this board meeting. And then we're also trying to fundraise.

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And then we're also trying to hit these numbers for investors. And we're also launching this new market. There's always a lot of things happening. But aligning yourself with one of the priorities is the most important thing. But you have to know what the priorities are. they don't have this as a goal and their KPIs what should we do guys? If they don't have goals or new guys? I mean they definitely have goals or new guys. Yeah but for example they need to generate more sales qualified leads and they have different channels for that. They can allocate their resources on like growing paid stewardship or something else. and probably what we feel like in things that all I just need to focus on my metrics

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I just need to focus on my conversions that we need to improve our marketing campaigns or something like that and probably they just don't think about our solution could help them in their... But then when you're thinking about those people right people that are not trying new things maybe not your best ICP right now. But people that are like, maybe they start a webinar series, maybe they've gone higher content writers to write more things. Maybe they're writing more thought pieces on LinkedIn. Like that would be a better customer because they're already putting money towards like solving the problem, right? That is like a trigger or a proxy for something, not just like, oh, you're just going to stay in your channel. Those are like a later adopter, right?

[02:05:31 - 02:06:18]
Because they need to see social proof, they need to see more things, they need to do more. That's not who you should target first, right? that have something that tells you they want to try new stuff, it's really important to them, they have a problem, they're buying things to solve that problem now. That was your first customer, right? Yeah, I think that's a problem. You're like going after two later. Yeah, or you're going after two later, save your people, right? Like they're not in the process yet, they're in the like learning that we have a problem process and then learning about options, right? Yeah. And you need to go after people to like know there's a problem and are looking for people that will buy now. Do you have a question? I'll just execute the idea. Okay. Great. ICPs. Okay. So when we're thinking about stakeholders and where they go, right, we're thinking about

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putting them in buckets of like our core target group, the people that we're talking to, that our people we're targeting right away, direct stakeholders and indirect stakeholders, right, and thinking about where to put them in our group, right, we're taking them from here. So I'm saying our people here are saying Zoe is my core target group, Vanessa is for marketing. I think this is easier to read if you guys look at it on your thing. It's a little boring up here. And then our direct stakeholders are people who are still involved, right, that are either the technical, technical stakeholder, or they're an influencer or they're a coach, and then some indirect stakeholders. So like the CEO is an indirect stakeholder, right? Probably not ever going to talk to them at a larger company, right? But like they care about what's happening, right? They care about the P&L, they care about all the department's budgets,

[02:07:03 - 02:07:50]
they care about the results that people are getting. They do care, right? And see the results and changes from the same with like an SDR, right? An SDR is also not going to be the direct person I'm selling to, but they are impacted by selling the marketing software. Like they're impacted by the number of M2Ls and then by next S2Ls that they bring

into the company, right? So I want you thinking about where people fall, where these stakeholders are, and how you're interacting with them, and how you're building content or value propositions for them. Because often, with your stakeholders, when it goes up for approval for someone else, depending on the size of the company, or if it goes down, the same way if you sell high, and someone's like, great, we're not going to use this tool. Say I bought a sales tool, and people are like, I'm absolutely not using that.

[02:07:50 - 02:08:40]
Cool, you bought it. Not going to use it. this is a hard process for us because we're really excited and the person who's the economic buyer was really excited but now this is the people who are used to use it because it's actually really hard for them to put their work through and they don't want to do it. Right? And then you're like, well this, I should have been thinking about them also. Thinking about like their honor, thinking about how they would use it as an end user because they are a stakeholder too. Because if you sell something and your end users don't want to use it, that's going to be a really big uphill battle for you. Right? Okay. Where do stakeholders fit in the buying process? Every customer that you're going to talk to is going to push the stakeholders that you want to talk to, like the BPs or CROs, people that are on fire. They want to push them to the end, right? Because they want to do all of the research. They want to find all the things. They want to bring proposals. They want to say, here's the thing, right?

[02:08:40 - 02:09:24]
But you want to talk to them really early. You're like, we want them early. I want to talk to them on discovery call because I want to ask them all the questions. I want to align with your priorities because I don't want to try to fight you later. And so that's going to be something that you should think about in terms of how can you get them to bring them on earlier. Like an example when I was talking earlier, if someone was like, no, I'm the decision maker. It's just going to decide and you ask more about how things are usually first internally, what the process looks like. And you learn that it's more people that are involved or someone else is going to send off on it. And say, next step, what we usually do, for people like you that are solving this problem, is our next step, we invite X, Y, and Z, these other stakeholders on the call. We go through things. We have a starting session. It's about 30 minutes.

[02:09:25 - 02:09:59]
Who would you like to invite on this phone? Or we'd love to have this VP, this person on the call. It's usually who we have. And you frame it as, this is what normal people do. This is what usually happens. Could you bring them to the call? It would be really nice if you could bring them to the call and we'd really like to talk to them. No, they're not saying they tell you now. Right? But when you frame it as like a social norm, right? And think that like next step, this is what we do. Then it's more weird if they're like, well, we don't want to do that. And you're like, oh, like usually in the process that we do, here's how we help, right? Here's how we align with things. If you're not comfortable doing that yet,

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what would make you comfortable? Why do I want to invite you to the phone? Right? But being more direct and asking. It's totally fine to do, but it's just also being comfortable pushing back and asking those things. Yes? Okay. Problems and pain points. These we're going to do after lunch. So you guys did great. Thanks for sitting here two hours. I know that's a long time. Some days, that was probably going to be done. So grab your food and we will be cooking in the petro session on the camera. So food is already served.

Session 2: Fundraising planning

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Recording duration: 01:09:17. Times below are local to this recording.

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[00:00:14 - 00:00:18]
Okay, everyone here, sloping their food.

[00:00:32 - 00:01:18]
Thank you. Anyways, so here's the deal. I have to repeat a lot of the stuff that I'm presenting here today. I have to repeat it over and over and over during office hours with the batch companies, which is very frustrating. So every batch I hope that it will be better than the previous one. I mean you guys will be the best one. But it's very important that you listen to us here. It will be recorded and then the next time you come to ask for my time, spend one hour to repeat this, I'm not going to do that.

[00:01:18 - 00:02:07]
Because it's recorded, you can go and listen to the record. So what I want is I want to now members and share key principles and key strategies for you to prepare for your next fundraising round. Whether that's a small round, start 500k or if it's a 2 million round, doesn't matter. and I want you to retain those principles and you try to apply all the stuff I shared today and then when you come back to me or I'm asking for support with your fundraising rounds, you already did your homework. If you come to us and you ask us basically what was already shared today or in front of the video, then we will be very frustrated. As you can understand, we want to help everyone.

[00:02:07 - 00:02:52]
we have interested in you guys fundraising but the portfolio is now close to 100 companies and we're not scalable. So we have stopped doing things that don't scale. Back to the beginning of this morning. I can't differ from the next bunch. Come again? From the next bunch. From the next bunch what? Stop doing things that are not scalable. Stop doing. No. I've been saying that for many battles now. This is my most recent portfolio but I have fund before this with 65 companies. My time has to be very well efficiently used. As I think you've probably already noticed by the way.

[00:02:54 - 00:03:41]
The fundraising process is complex, there's many different steps to it. but at the end of the day is like a sales process. That's point number one. So everything you hear in the program around creating a funnel, qualifying the leads, getting through the funnel and closing them, that's exactly what fundraising is about. With one extra nuance is that with the investors as you're progressing them through this funnel, you have to be building relationships at a deeper level than you would with a client. But otherwise it's sales principles at work. I'm not going to obviously have time to cover all these things in 40 minutes or so.

[00:03:41 - 00:04:26]
So I will skip some stuff. I will cover the ones that really matter. And I will use the clicker because it exists. First thing is to decide if you need to fundraise, when you need to fundraise and how much you need to fundraise. The way to go about this is to reverse engineer the rounds. So you first try to decide what you want to achieve with the next round, which will then determine what meaning, how much you want to raise, which will then determine how much revenue you need to be making at that time,

[00:04:27 - 00:05:15]
which will then determine how much growth you need between the point where you are at now and the revenue you need to have at that time. It's not rocket science, right? You can run the numbers. In fact, I think one of this slide, the slides that you'll get access to will show you a basic example. But if you're trying, if you're at 5k now, you're trying to, you will try to raise a series A, say at 15 million pre-money, you want a super aggressive multiplier of 15k, 15x, which is never going to happen. example, you would need to be at around 80-85k a month. So between 5k a month now and 85k

[00:05:15 - 00:06:06]
a month or 83k in this example, and you have say about 20 months to get there, what do you need to do in terms of monthly growth and controlling the burn to understand how much capital you need to get to those 83k right so if you

did the numbers it would be around 300 which means okay now i'm at 5k i want to get to 83k running the number from my per my my forecasts i need to raise 300k now to get to my series a of 15 million free money easy right might not be easy to come up with the assumptions of the burn or how much should the

[00:06:06 - 00:06:54]
multiplier be but this is a very good starting point because it tells you if you should be raising now or not because if you need 300k and you already have 300k from us and a few other angels problem solved. That's point number one. This is the point about the sales process but focusing on the KPIs. Each of you, not each of you, but several of you have different business models. For those different models, different KPIs will matter. That's one of the things we're working with you and inventors easy to these right so once you decide what those metrics are those will become core of

[00:06:54 - 00:07:42]
your fundraising narrative of your fundraising story so in some of you when you're very early maybe you do want to prove that you're very good at getting everyone to know you maybe you're a consumer play and it's very early so you're the evidence that the market wants you might just be we have like you know thousands and thousands of people just pre-signing, pre-ordering or pre-signing out from when we release. Some of you may be at the other extreme which is we're already making 50k a month and what we need to prove is that these 50k are renewable, they're already a repetitive sales process, a reputable sales process and then you have anything in between.

[00:07:42 - 00:08:29]
So you have to figure out at any given point of fundraising what are the metrics that will validate you to the investor. And one important point, each round, more than one important point, at least two important points, all these conversations around pre-seed, seed, pre-series A, series A, bridge, whatever, whatever you want to call it, that's largely bullshit. And when you hear rejections from investors that, oh, we only invest in seed but you're pre-seed or the other way around, often 99% of the time, that's just an easy excuse for

[00:08:29 - 00:09:19]
them because for whatever reason they don't want to invest and they use the stage of investment for that. What matters for an investment is how much you're raising in total. Do they want to be a big chunk of that or a small chunk of that? And does that, do the pieces of the puzzle fit for them? And what this means is if you then accept that there's no, that this nomenclature of precedes, seed, precedes, etc. is bullshit, what then matters is that each round has one goal and has one story. You may be doing a round to create awareness. You may be doing a round to launch your prototype. You may be doing a round because the prototype is already working well and you want to go to full-scale production.

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Every time you fundraise, regardless of the amount or the time that you do it, you have to have a very compelling story for that money. It could be for country expansion. We're in one country, now we're going to go to five. Right? So think about this. If every fundraising stage is one story. And you could even think like if you give yourself the time, you can do it like a book. Every fundraise I'm going to have maybe thinking two, three rounds ahead has a chapter. and each chapter is the story you tell when you're pitching that

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chapter at that round stage. And then that's where these metrics come in. Then you have different types of materials you're going to be asked, then you have different types of text, etc. Again, the point is, without going bullet by bullet, is you will have very basic text that you will use for example on our demo day or that you will use for some cold emailing where you just want to include there things that are impressive that get their attention get their curiosity at least and then that opens the conversation on the far extreme you obviously

[00:10:45 - 00:11:37]
have a deck where you already include a lot of stuff that sometimes it's even sensitive materials sharing things that are competitive information that the VC may use for other purposes. And so when you get to that stage then there's a different conversation of you know how careful do you want to be and is it on the deck, is it on the data room, do you share, do you not share, we will talk about that later. But I want you to take this also with you that there isn't just one deck. There are different decks for different purposes and for different levels of depth of your story. They will all be for

the same story, for the same round, but you're going to use them at different stages.

[00:11:41 - 00:12:37]
Then, I'm not going to teach you how to design investment decks now, but I want to cover a few things super, super quickly. First, the bullshit slides, right? It's a one trillion market, we can easily get 1%, it's a massive company, just give us the money. What you need to do is you need to do bottom-up analysis like this, assessments. How many ICPs are there, how much are they going to pay per year, that's my forecasted revenue potential. And then this one here I put as a more exotic thing, but it's an interesting concept when the farmers can pull it off, which is sometimes you're not in one specific vertical. Sometimes you're in the intersection of different verticals, like it could be ethe, coitxamfinte or something else.

[00:12:37 - 00:13:23]
and so with these we call it petal diagrams help you do is okay we're not just going after a one of the petals which is worth a billion we're actually going after two of them in the second one is three billion and so we're somewhere in here yes I just use it because some companies can pull this off nicely I would say in the middle is where the speed spot is for the most of you. Who knows the top reasons why startups fail? In investments, run out of money. No, the startup itself, why does it fail? They run out of money. They don't get to product market fit. They don't get product market fit.

[00:13:23 - 00:14:09]
They give up. Co-founders class. Say again? They don't know the market. They don't know the market? Okay. Yes. That goes market strategy. That goes market strategy. Okay. So a lot of reasons can lead to Star Trek failing and a lot of studies have been done. And the reality is, regardless of the studies out there, what's the main reason for companies to fail is because there's no marketing. You run out of money because you're not you. Someone runs, your example was, people run out of money because they're trying to create

[00:14:09 - 00:14:53]
need for something that doesn't exist. right or the founder start fighting because the market really doesn't want what they have and each of them wants to go in a different direction and so they don't get product market fit because the market doesn't want it and so the reason why we spend so much time in the first two weeks of the program trying to identify your right your ideal is exactly because of that we want to validate that there's need for what you have because if there isn't we still have time to course correct we still have time to figure out something else Can I ask a question? Does the buy doesn't mean that the problem exists?

[00:14:54 - 00:15:37]
If they buy? Depends how many of them buy and it depends if they buy repetitively or if they just buy one once So this elusive concept of product market fit, no one knows how to define it. That's the reality. I think the retention was about the first payment. And the problem if we try to identify if these problems exist. So I think it's about the first payment. This is a problem. It's a problem for that one client at that one client. Yeah, for sure. Might not be for another client. The second question is how many clients have the same problem. They realize that they have this problem.

[00:15:40 - 00:16:29]
Is it correct that some startups make something new that nobody knows and no one wants to buy it because they cannot pitch it correctly, that is a very specific thing, like someone who's trying to create a new category. Okay, are you Airbnb? No. And the reality is even Airbnb had couch surfing as an example. even Google had hot search or whatever, hot mail, whatever, right? The reality is there was always someone else doing it before. But fair, sometimes it's a thing that is fairly new to the market, so it takes longer to explain.

[00:16:29 - 00:17:17]
It is a challenge, you have to evangelize the market about it, I agree. So the start tech may fail because they're ahead of the curve. That's what it means. one quote because it's my pain point I'm asking myself every day is it some maybe numbers from your perspective that validates that this problem exists some numbers of clients in B2B for example or in B2C or how do you understand as an investor that okay they validate that at least this problem exists maybe the solution isn't right not good enough for many reasons but the problem is... Well, there isn't a magic answer to that.

[00:17:18 - 00:18:06]
As a company there are things you can do which is doing 50 interviews a week, 100 interviews a week and from that you get a statistically significant signal that the people you are talking to, all of them without you mentioning it, talk about the problem. That's validation. You've talked with 100 people and 80 of them said that they're having this problem. And I never told them about the problem. I just asked them about their lives, because that's another thing

you're learning these two weeks is how to interview people without leading with questions or without leading questions. Right? So that would be the way to prove that the problem exists. How do you prove the solution is what they want? For example, continuous growth on net

[00:18:06 - 00:18:59]
new revenue. Now you tell me, okay, what's the percentage of net new revenue that proves product market fit? I mean, there's no magic number. 20% a month, that's a good number, You know, it's consistency. I think the best way to me, the ideal way to prove product market fit is when you've done a sales process so many times now that it works always the same way. It's always repetitive and you don't have to worry too much about changing any of the levers. You know, I do this for acquisition, I use this channel, they will come in through the email, they'll come in through that, they're going to click here, they're going to do that.

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And once that is working as a well-oiled machine, that's true product market fit. But the reality is many companies are our product. This is another important point is that product market fit is not eternal. You may have product market fit today and lose it tomorrow, right? And so we always have to continue adjusting to the market conditions to make sure that we're always fit to what the market needs. That's also another important thing to do. What do I want to say about this? These days it's very hard to find someone who's doing something new for the first time. Someone has tried it, someone is trying it, someone succeeded at trying it, someone failed at trying it.

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So we will work a lot with you and already are still asking a lot of questions because we still want to believe that there is one unique angle

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for each of you that you can use then in your marketing and your sales materials and that's you know your your entry point into the market right but it may be that there isn't something maybe it's just okay you know Redley is doing it but we're doing it better than them because of our background, because of our experience, you know, or, you know, there's a lot of devices out there, but who the fuck wants another bracelet except me? And it's better to have a phone or a camera, right? So we, the point is, try to find that uniqueness, but if you don't find it, and that's more and more likely, especially in AI days, then you're, then it becomes,

[00:20:48 - 00:21:32]
everything is about storytelling your go-to-market strategy and it's in repetitive sales so I already talked to an inventor this morning about this in our team meeting that and I mentioned to you when I was standing here for the standout that your competitive advantage over technology is reducing over time very fast so you have to continue increasing your competitive advantage sales in storytelling exponentially over time if you want to rise up the noise as this slide tracks you. Okay, team. Also a very important point in everyone says the same things.

[00:21:34 - 00:22:25]
Ideally not a solo founder even though these days everyone romanticizes this idea that they will be the first solo founder to reach a trillion dollar company. maybe but i think we're not all playing for that game right so even if you are a solo founder even if you have 100 agents with you it is important that you surround yourself with a couple people that have that can offer you different perspectives different angles question your assumptions and so if they're not co-founders they're not co-founders but maybe they're senior hires maybe they're very close advisors maybe they're your investors so make sure you have that from the beginning second thing these people whether they're hires or co-founders or advisors they have to

[00:22:26 - 00:23:13]
complement your gaps and you have to first and foremost accept your gaps you're a tech guy or you're a sales guy or something in between and then you have to find people that know the things you don't know. You know in engineering you probably heard the concepts of known unknowns and unknown unknowns and all of that. As founders we definitely need to recognize our unknown unknowns. There's shit out there that I don't know, I don't know. And so you need people around you that will tell you about it. We need people that have seen it like 10 times, 100 times. and that will help you build a better product, a better solution. And then lastly, teams need to evolve with the markets.

[00:23:13 - 00:24:04]
When you're looking for a CTO now, that CTO is likely, very likely, not going to be the CTO that's going to take you from your first 100 users to your 100,000 users. So one thing that the VCs will look for when you're talking to them about fundraising in the English fundraising rounds is, is this person someone that will be able to attract different levels of talent at different stages of the company. Sure, they're doing a really cool thing now but they were all friends from high school or college but what's going to happen when shit hits the fan, in the next round things get harder, the markets get less friendly and they need to bring someone else that knows more than them. Is this a CEO who's going to be able to bring someone who knows more than them?

[00:24:04 - 00:24:52]
It doesn't mean replacing them, but someone to join them on another role, CTO, CRO, CTO, whatever. Right? So being able to prove to the investors that you can attract talent and that people like working with you and they stick with you. even when you run out of money they're going to work for you for free for a few months until you raise the next round. That's a characteristic that the VCs would really like to see. Okay, the product I will skip but I will make a comment. Don't make silly stuff when you're sending decks with competitive analysis tables and many of you did this when you send us your decks. So the point here is, or two points actually, with two different directions.

[00:24:53 - 00:25:43]
The two by twos. It's always pretty silly to do a two by two where you always be the only one on one of the quadrants. Usually it's the top by the quadrants. Because on one hand means, well, maybe, are you saying everyone is stupid and you're the right mind that after a decade discover that that quadrant is there? No, there has to be more people around there, you just have to be different enough from them. Or you can say, listen, this quadrant is worth one trillion, who the fuck cares if there's five dogs there? Because it's still a lot of market for each of the five of us. But that is the narrative. But the narrative of, no, no, no, we're like, we're the unites. That's bullshit. And what's even worse is when the dimensions of the 2x2 are shitty stuff like,

[00:25:44 - 00:26:32]
better usability, things that are not competitive advantages. No one wants to compete on price, no one knows how to measure usability. So if you ever do this, pick dimensions that are tangible, incredible and then if someone asks you, prove me how you're better on that dimension, you can show them the feature or the set of features that you have that do it better than anyone else. which is something that you can do with a table like this. But again, don't use a table where you have like 10 features and you're better than anyone at all the 10 features. Because first, the market doesn't care about the 10 features. Most likely, 2 or 3 of those features drive 80% of the value for your clients.

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So focus on those and focus on proving credibly that you're better than the competitors on those 2 or 3 that have value. I may not have asked this to all of you, but I'm sure I asked to many of you who had a table like this. Tell me which of these 10 features actually add the most value to your planet. Now tell me why. Why you're better than the others. Okay, so traction. This is another interesting point, important point. It has to do with the reverse engineering point that I need at the beginning. that growth, the example I gave you from 5k to 83k is a linear example. Like no one called me out on that. But it shouldn't be a linear example.

[00:27:20 - 00:28:05]
It should be some form of exponential growth. And so it is okay if for the first five or six months of those 20 months that we talked to that example, You're still figuring things out, but what you need to know is, what you need to find out is at some point in that process you need to figure out what we call the growth levels. I know that if I put X amount in this type of user acquisition campaign, it will result in X percent conversion. And I know that if I make that bet for three months, I will be burning cash, but the user numbers that I want or the revenue that I want start going up faster.

[00:28:06 - 00:28:57]
Okay. So then you decide, okay, now I know this works. I'm going to hold my cards in three months before the fundraise or four months before the, it's not scientific, but between three and six months of the fundraise, I'm going put my chips on this game and I'm going to put 100k, 100 dollars, 200 dollars, a thousand dollars, whatever it is on this campaign because it's going to start getting my numbers going up into the right faster and that's when you start interacting more frequently with the investors and that's when they start saying okay last week it was this and this week is this and next week is that so momentum momentum is important and you can create the momentum as long as the flat time of your growth you're figuring out what doesn't work. And these are exactly what the next two months

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should be about, is identifying your growth layers. What can you do that will trigger growth more effectively than anything else? Okay, and this is like probably the closest to the sales process that I was talking about. You have to have your CRM for investors. And that CRM, which Anne and I will work a lot with you, has to include all these things and maybe even more. But what I would like to emphasize here is that when we ask you for...

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Sorry, I'll emphasize this thing in the next slide. What you need to do with this Yaran and these days building this with AI takes one minute. you guys are super lucky because

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you know the previous batches before batch 8, 9 even, it would take a lot of research time to build a CRM office. Now AI does this for you. You have to curate it after but you have a starting point in a matter of minutes right. But it's important to qualify the investors on several of these things that are invested here and so the typical stuff you hear right it's the stage of investment how much do they invest what verticals do they invest do they invest in competitors or not in case they already have a competitor in the portfolio that is all of this right what's important in this CRM for us is that you are able to prioritize them based on all

[00:30:51 - 00:31:32]
And why is that? Because there is investors that you really really want and you don't want to fuck it up with them. So those are certainly not the first ones you're going to talk to. What we want is we want you to know, okay here's the guys that if really things are really really balancing their money but you know otherwise I rather pass. Those are the ones you're going to talk to first. Because you're going to commit so many mistakes on your materials, on your pitch, on how you handle the negotiations with them. We want you to train on the bad ones, because then you go after the better ones next. And that prioritization needs to be part of the CRM.

[00:31:44 - 00:32:42]
Objections. VCs, I already gave you an example. We only invest in your stage, you're a pre-C, but we only invest in C. So the best way to go about objections is as you're building the relationship with them over time. I'll come back to this topic of building the relationship over time. You always never miss an opportunity when you run into BBC online or in person, never miss an opportunity to ask them questions the same way you ask a client to understand why the client would not buy or does not want to buy you. So ask them basically to help you build, not directly this way, but through the conversation, build from that conversation like your homework, your list of to do's.

[00:32:42 - 00:33:27]
This guy told me he's not going to invest, or this girl told me she's not going to invest unless I'm in five countries, or unless I'm doing 50k a month, or unless this, or unless that. Create that list, because the next time you talk to them and you work on that list, there will be no objections from that list. And you're forcing the VC to give you more excuses. Eventually they'll run out of excuses. And they'll say, we don't like that. That's going to break their heart. But eventually, eventually that will happen very late in life, and you're already raised from another guy. Right? So objections is something that you prevent by learning from these conversations.

[00:33:28 - 00:34:15]
Ask a lot of questions to VCs, smart questions. questions to qualify them and then questions to understand why, what they want to see from you. I can also flip this the other way around. I told you, identify the objections, but also identify the goals, like the example of the five countries or 50K a month or other things like that. Okay, sources for introduction. So we do our own work of making sure that we have our network of you to, but we don't know all the VCs in the world. And when it comes to some vertical applications, you might know VCs that we don't know, or you may try to get to VCs that you

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don't know and we don't know, but we may be able to get to them warmer or faster. But But this needs to be a joint work. So we will share with you at one point, we will share with you at some point a list of people that we and me personally are connected to, so that we'll help you with some introductions. But then we also expect that, We also expect that you will give us your list of people that you are planning to talk to, so that we can help you qualify that list too.

[00:35:01 - 00:35:50]
One thing you will do is you will create your CRM, you'll make it live and share it with us, so you can collaborate with that file. There's other things to be said here about hacks, which is, you know, try to identify, try to track them online. I'm not a big fan of spending too much time and money to go to events, but if something is, someone is really critical, you can have alerts and you can know if they're going to speak at some place ahead of time. you can make sure to come into this person on the elevator or on the hallway, if not with a schedule of meeting, which would be the ideal. Okay, now, Alana and I will help you with introductions, like I said, but we need to make sure that those introductions are effective and that we're scalable.

[00:35:51 - 00:36:40]
So there is something we will, this is like pinned to your Slack channel, it's in the programs website it's in this slide and I bet like a finger that half of you is gonna ask me for this shit still in the next two months. It's always like so what do we want with this? When I was talking about qualifying the DCs on the CRM I gave you the generic examples of stage, amount of investment, vertical etc. For a really good warm introduction we need to take that one step further. In that step further is I want to talk, I don't want just to be introduced to this VC firm, I

[00:36:40 - 00:37:31]
want to be introduced to this partner in this VC firm, not just because the partner is in this VC firm because this partner is like one of the best investors in this type of solutions or because this partner said these things online or at an event and this exactly matches our mission. So when we're emailing this person, either you or us coldly, and we can say you know what you said XYZ at you know this conference and you know what that's exactly what we built or that's exactly the profile of the clients we're going after right so this person then is like okay these guys we're aligned at least in some intellectual level maybe it's worth having a conversation so that's a warm introduction

[00:37:32 - 00:38:20]
Yes, or better said, that's the beginning of the work. And then you add a few more things at the bottom, which is as much as possible, the impressive metrics. We already did this, or we're doing that. Something that when they read, they're like, okay, these guys have worked half an hour of my time, 15 minutes of my time. Or they're not worth my time, but I think an analyst should talk to them for 15 minutes and see what that takes. So this is the structure of the forward intro email. We will continue repeating this video, forward intro email. This is the anatomy of it. And then, you know, let's keep this. Did I get to the end of it? Sorry. I'm just too far.

[00:38:21 - 00:39:07]
Now, building the relationships, as I was saying, we invest in lines, not in bugs, which means that no one asks, no one likes to be asked for money. Do you like to be asked for money? No, no one likes. And even worse, no one likes to be begged for money, which is what many founders do. So to avoid that, what you do is you start ahead of time, now that you know, you know, back to the beginning of this example at the beginning, you have 16 months, 18 months, 20 months until you raise. You have all that time to figure out from your CRM who are the guys you really want from the category. And you have all that time to start promoting interactions with them.

[00:39:07 - 00:39:57]
it can be always online, it can be through events, but once you have them, once you have the ability to send them updates, you start building a line. And then you have to be smart about, you know, the data points that you put in there, obviously. If you're not growing, then don't email them every week. but figure out what's a good cadence for updates and when you reach out to them you have something impressive hey you know what this week we signed up you know for this week week or in this month we continue our growth and we double revenue so every time they these days it's not going to be them it's going to

[00:39:57 - 00:40:00]
there's some agent within their inbox, sees

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that number going up and up and up and up and they're like the alarm bells start ringing on the investor's CRM and they're like this company is hot we need to go talk to them before someone else takes a deal before us so build the relationship over time and create this line over time there's a point here in this very worthy slide which is also and I alluded to it very briefly. Sometimes partners don't have time for you. Sometimes principals have more time for you. Associates and analysts have even more time for you. And they have a vested interest like their performance is based on how many good deals

[00:40:47 - 00:41:36]
they bring to the partners table. So yes you can shoot for the stars and try to do cold calls intros to partner level and for regional investors usually there's not all these layers that I just described it's like a partner they need an associate right but you can shoot for the higher level but also keep in mind that it doesn't hurt to start conversations very early with the associates because for those it's okay to I wouldn't say burn the relationship but it's okay to give them you know, so-so metrics because they they're willing to wait another month, two months, three months and then when you have the good metrics there will still be your friends because again it's their job to make sure they're good friends with the best with the best founders. So explore

[00:41:36 - 00:42:26]
the different levels of seniority in a VC firm smartly with this email. Okay, and then quickly for the last round. When you have decided when you're going to fundraise, the ideal is to try and concentrate as many meetings as you can in a small window of time. Sometimes it's easier said than done. I'm just giving you what's the ideal scenario be ideal right and there's several reasons to do that first less time distracted from building the from building the business second if you start getting offers you start getting them all at

[00:42:26 - 00:43:13]
about the same time third if you get if you get more of them at the same time you get the leverage to negotiate them against each other right and you create buzz in the market and believe me the market is very small even though we're here in Silicon Valley it's far there people talk a lot and when the word goes out that a company is needing a b and c in a span of two weeks someone's like okay something's going on because these guys are talking to everyone I don't want to be the stupid one that's left out. I'm going to take a meeting too. So concentrate as much as possible your meetings in time because that will help you

[00:43:15 - 00:44:05]
have more negotiation power when you start getting the term sheets. Another thing that's important that comes out of it is you may you may get offers from good investors and bad investors and you want to make sure that as much as possible you get the offers from the good investors first because if you spread the meetings out too much in time and you end up talking to the weaker investors first you're going to get an offer from them and then you have to decide do I take this offer from a tier two investor or do I take my chances of letting it expire and wait another month to talk to the tier one who told me they want to talk in a

[00:44:05 - 00:44:55]
month and then I may or not get an investment from them right so if you concentrate the meetings more likely these two offers will be coming closer together and you have a little bit more flexibility to negotiate and choose the best investors out of all so two weeks ago I had a short call with one partner which runs from Texas and a few days ago they sent messages that they want to follow a call with two partners together and keeping in mind this kind of momentum timeline and considering about whether should I like tell them that guys we are at the prussian right now we are focusing on the revenue

[00:44:55 - 00:45:44]
maybe we need to make a call a bit later I will send you like update something or should I accept this call That actually connects with this point. The FOMO you create with the window, the calendar. So that's another hack way is, let's say you decide you're going to fundraise for two, three weeks. You create a calendar just for that or some calendar too for that, right? You don't open all the slots at the same time. You just open a few because you want them to go there and say, oh shit, these guys must be busy. Either they're busy building the company, which is a good thing, or they're busy talking to other investors, which is awful for me as a investor. So I want to talk to them.

[00:45:44 - 00:46:36]
So then you open slots as they start to get votes. So that's another way to create some And to your point, everyone knows that if you ask for money you get advice, if you ask for advice you get money. And so when people are coming to you for these meetings, if you really don't need the money right now, and you do not have that momentum on the curve that I showed before, it's totally fine to say our round is not open, we don't need capital now, we're doing a bunch of cool stuff on the product and working on the metrics, we will definitely come back to you when we open the round.

[00:46:36 - 00:47:21]
And then they can be the ones that are already on your list of updates. Yeah. But it's fine to say no to meetings if it's not the right time to raise. Or even better, you take the meeting, but before that you say, listen, we can talk, we'd love to hear your views on the market, we'd love to share what we're doing, but I want to be upfront, we're not fundraising. Yeah. So then they decide, okay, I don't want to waste time because I really want to deploy fast. These guys are not going to take my money now. I don't want to talk. You let them decide. But to my earlier point, the more you talk to them, the more you learn from them, the more you know what you need to prepare when you open the round. You can try and take the call, but just manage your expectations that way. Okay, good.

[00:47:27 - 00:48:18]
Yeah, one last thing because I think I thought I had a... Okay, I wanted to go here. A bunch of you are going to come to me and say, hey, we really want to meet ACC. Like, they're the best investor in the world. But here's how funds work. every investor, especially Silicon Valley and American investors, they expect each investor, each investment they make to return their funds. What that means is they know how much they estimate how much they're going to put in a company, they estimate how much they will own of that company equity wise when the company gets to an exit and they want to know that when they sell that chunk of equity in the markets, whether it's an IPO or M&A,

[00:48:19 - 00:49:04]
that chunk of dollars has to be equal to the size of the fund they've invested from. So think about that. You go talk to Andreessen, their funds are billion plus now, right? 10 billion, trillion. So you have to be an exit of that level almost for you to marry to them. And so now you can adjust this to all the mid-sized VCs in Europe too. So another question you can ask them when you're qualifying them is what are you looking for in your companies? Are you only betting on someone that can get to unicorn level? Are you a fund that looks for 10x on every investment? So often the funds will be honest about it. Here's what we need.

[00:49:04 - 00:49:55]
And if you're looking at regional investment, the return the fund rule is obviously not scientific. Many of them, you know, if you get to 100 million, everyone's going to be very happy, right? So, the point is, adjust your expectations to the fund's expectations and only talk to the ones where these are aligned. Because otherwise you're going to be wasting their time and your time. Peter, first thing I'll go to you. Just to clarify what you said, so if there's a fund of like 100 million dollars, right? They are wanting that, let's say they acquire 10% of equity in our company. Yeah, sorry I forgot about the example. And they are expecting basically the 10% that they invest in us, those 10% will be at least 100 million.

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So you need to exit at 1B. That

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was the idea around A60. Yeah. So that's where the R is from. You can tell. Yes? He asked the question. Okay. And then last but not least, because we're past the time, the learning from the rejections. I have one follow up question, when it takes it should be one billion, it is 500 million still acceptable I think so right? You would appreciate it being your answer now. Because one billion is not a lot right? Yes, the return to the fund equation is not also scientific but it has to be fairly aligned.

[00:50:49 - 00:51:35]
like one order of magnitude difference and there's no point in talking about it. Because there's not too many $400 million funds. It's right. What is the 500-degree fund? Our fund? Yeah. So the part is... But I'm five times more than many, so it goes back to a billion again. Okay, last point, rejections. It sucks to get notes, right? But you're going to get

notes 90% of the time. That's the reality. So what we need to do is we need to make the best of those notes. So when the investor gives you a note that is just, sorry, we're

[00:51:35 - 00:52:20]
going to pass, or sorry, you're not on our stage, going back to our example from many times a day just reply friendly like accepting the rejection in a way but asking more questions we would love to get better for the next round we would love to understand you know what did we miss or are you out for good or are you out for now but if we do xyz we may get into a conversation later Are you out on this round, but you may in on the next round? So try to ask the relevant questions for that to learn from each projection, so that you can take at least some value out of the number.

[00:52:21 - 00:53:13]
It could even be like they tell you no because we don't know your vertical, which is stupid because if they don't know your vertical, they shouldn't be talking to you at all. But let's say they say that, well, you know, we're not comfortable with this vertical, we're not going to invest. Then you ask okay so who are the funds in this vertical that you respect? Would you be able to make introductions to these guys? Because if you liked us but you didn't like the vertical just introduce me to your friends in that vertical. So it's always like always think once you're like one step ahead two steps ahead of their response to learn more. Question on that. The thing that I heard that if you are asking for interest from the investors that have not invested in you, it's kind of a bad thing because the interest that they will try to make, they don't ask them the same. Why do you do that?

[00:53:13 - 00:54:00]
No, but that's why I use the vertical example. Obviously, they say, well, we don't like you because we don't believe in your solution or because your metrics suck or your team is in conflict. You don't want a warm introduction from these guys. It's in cases where the rejection is plausible. It could be a side statement. It could be, listen, you want, you're raising a million, but we only write, you know, a million plus tickets and we cannot own the whole round. and then you can say okay introduce me to the guys who usually invest upstream from you. Like who have you invested in the past with like as a coin investor. So there has to be a good one.

[00:54:03 - 00:54:54]
Okay, a few more questions. What is one trick that you use that share one 32,000 investors? That you can use to create one, like one thing that you only learn with the job. I mean I think they're all here, all of these are from personal experience. But the thing unfortunately that does drive most PCs is phone. if you tell them somewhat credibly, this is a very dangerous game to play, but if it's well played, it can work out very well. If you can tell them credibly, you're talking to X friends that you know they compete against, they're like, okay, we need to talk to these guys, right?

[00:54:54 - 00:55:40]
But that's why the analyst and associates work, because it's easy to have an associate from Andreessen talk to you. then we can say well we're talking to Andreessen. It's not a good example because no one will believe that Andreessen will invest in a company at this stage from Eastern Europe very unlikely, right? But a better example would be, okay, we're talking to five different VCs this week, we will happily share their names if the conversation between us progresses. So this season they like, they fear competition. So if you get in these conversations creating a sense of home in their head, they are more likely to take a call from you. Yeah. Thank you.

[00:55:42 - 00:56:35]
I just want to understand that, for example, I am in touch with Plug and Play adventures, like, pretty actively, to be honest, even before you guys. Is there some type of competition like they don't tell me or is there some underlying psychological? It's being recorded and I cannot respond to that question. No, we don't see that as competition. But I cannot respond, your question is more to them because you were saying are they not going to help me because I'm a 500 company, I don't know. We have plug and play companies in our portfolio, we have startup wiseguys, today's another regional accelerator program, we have Alchemist, we have Handler, we help all these companies, they are our portfolio, from the moment you guys are investing in you, I'm going to help you, I don't care if there's another competitor on the council.

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What I would, without making it personal to plug and play, is make sure that the investors you're talking to, especially these ones that have a hybrid model of accelerator funds, that you're really talking to them about direct investment with a tangible deadline, and it's not like, okay, maybe if you do these things or these small accelerator programs here with we'll show you to our investors in the US fund and maybe we'll raise from them. That's the important thing. In our

region, in CE, that brand and other brands have a lot of programs like that. You do the program, at the end maybe the best of the best will go to the US and there maybe you get a meeting

[00:57:25 - 00:58:10]
with the investors from the US fund and then maybe you raise money at that time. So the founders have to decide is this cost of opportunity worth it or not and that's why explicitly we say 100 euros invests in front in the founders right away we don't need to test it for three months to decide if we want to to have another portfolio that's a big difference Are there any evc's that you made and you would tell us no i don't know I've never seen this. No, but there's, yeah, I mean, there's investors we know better than others, there's investors we know to be more problematic than others,

[00:58:10 - 00:58:58]
and we will tell you that, of course. Like, what reminds of your space? Because they drag things for too long, they ask for, like, a hundred documents, and the likelihood of them investing is always very low, and it's a small ticket, and you're like, and we're going to tell you, if you talk to this VC, if you're in mind already in this region, it's going to take six months of due diligence, and they're going to say 80% no to your type of investment. And if they say yes, it's going to be like 50. Is it worth it? Six months of your time? Probably not. So we will share that information privately with you guys. How can you understand if an investor is a bad fit to the company and not because of their pure value?

[00:58:59 - 00:59:48]
Let's say they are very fast and very limited. How do you realize that it is a bad fit if you push the founders to make bad decisions just to prove growth, for example? If an investor talks more than he listens, it's not a great investor. Unfortunately that describes 90% of the investors. If an investor has spent most of the time giving you advice rather than asking you questions before giving you advice, that's not a great investor. because investors are unfortunately 99.9% alpha males and females and they think they know it all.

[00:59:49 - 00:59:59]
So they like to come and show their open chest and you should be a B2B company. You should be a B2B company.

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[01:00:01 - 01:00:52]
You know, so it's when you interact with them, you have to understand if they're really vested in helping you, or if they're more interested in doing what they want you to do. And obviously this is not black or white, because sometimes they will know more than you. Sometimes the advice is warranted. but you have to understand where they're coming from and it has to be you know lastly is it has to be someone that if it's someone that you're gonna have to interact a lot because for example it's already a series A they're gonna go on your board and you have to you have to decide is this someone I can face every month and have like good beings or is this person an asshole and I don't

[01:00:53 - 01:01:44]
So that's ultimately also right there. More questions? Well, I mean the timeline, so you have the steps over there and then it always changes. And sometimes something by spreading out and when do we cut basically the funding to save all the time? like you know this is the theory but you don't have Excel so you find this like investor and all the other yeah I mean it takes courage to stop the process when it's extending too long but often it has to be done so if you feel like you've given this investor all the data points they needed

[01:01:44 - 01:02:34]
and they keep asking for more, you will understand at some point that they're really just not certain they're going to invest. And then you can tell them, listen, as you can understand, my focus is building the business. I've spent 100 hours in due diligence for your company, we're still not there, so let's do this. You tell me what's ultimately the metrics or the achievements that you need to see from us in the data room, by when, for this round to close. If they don't have both, then you say, clearly you don't know what you want from us, so let's pause the process. We're going to go build a business, we're going to go talk to other investors, but with you it seems like it's not going to go. The important thing is, however you handle the conversations with the VCs, just be very transparent with them and put the cards on the table.

[01:02:35 - 01:03:23]
And then they can never accuse you for having abused their time, abused their experience, abused their network.

You're like, listen, I'm a founder, this is my goal. Are you going to contribute to that goal in the next three months, six months, whatever timeline you're negotiating for? Good. You're not? Then, sir, we'll save you your time. There's a bunch of companies out there for you to invest, just to invest. And I almost assure you that when you tell no to them, that's when they get more interested. unfortunately. That's what I did one time, very good. But, it's not all. Okay, Diana has a session to run. To wrap this up, why? We have a lot of, you know, Slush, Take Chill, Startup Fair, all of these

[01:03:23 - 01:04:09]
exhibitions. Why? Or Zoom call? What do you think? Because you mentioned this alpha moment, and then I'm thinking I mean, our founders, we also have some sort of feedback on whether we like, whether this is our... I say you take whatever you can. You can do it online. If you're cool online, you can do more. It's more scalable. It's cheaper. We do it online. I don't think, I mean I cannot speak for all the DC's, but I don't hear that much around I still need to meet this person to make the investment for the level of investment here. I mean we get to see if things change. They want to come to the office, they want to visit, they want to see what's going on. but for you now

[01:04:09 - 01:04:57]
it doesn't matter some more questions I had some discussions with funds from Silicon Valley and they asked me about whether our teams are located and I think that probably for some of them it is a point yeah like our environment to be location in the US, at least in the US. What do you think? I think that it depends on company by company, on your business model, on the market. I think that in many cases if the company is exploring the US market, the CEO or the co-founders,

[01:04:58 - 01:05:47]
CRO, whoever is responsible for sales at that point, needs definitely to spend some time in the US. If nothing else, to understand how sales are done in the US and be able to hire proper sales teams in the US. Do you need to live there full time? Maybe. I think it depends on many investors because if you show to them that you can be equally effective with a small sales maybe slash product team in the US, but everyone else operations, engineering, customer support, support elsewhere, they're also not stupid. they don't understand their dollars go further if the costs are lower by having the team distributed

[01:05:47 - 01:06:33]
that way. I mean, I... now there's a big, big height because of the AI that, you know, all the AI talent is in the valley. I don't agree with that, but I think I'm one of the few voices still saying that. I'm still pushing for AI here, but a lot of people are saying you have to be there. I don't agree with that. But you have to understand, again to the conversation of this is the right investor or not, you have to understand why they are asking you to be there. Some of them have very good reasons, you can get them from the conversation and you give them the reason. You are right, I should be here, or I should be here in six months or a year and then we will figure it out.

[01:06:33 - 01:07:21]
Others are just imposing that blind rule. Oh, I only invest in teams who are in the US. And then you're like, well, clearly you've never been to Eastern Europe. Bye-bye. Or come to Eastern Europe so I can show you, and then you'll understand why we keep engineering teams there. So that's what we do with our demo day. We try to bring a lot of international investors here. some of them I pay, we pay from our budget for them to come here because they're important investors and then when they go back to London, San Francisco, Berlin, they're going to talk to their peers and they're going to say I went there, it's actually amazing. and we create ambassadors that work. So when an investor sounds skeptical about your region,

[01:07:21 - 01:08:07]
they also do that. I mean, a trip to the region, maybe they'll cut. Is it a good idea to include in the narration for the next round that creates money to relocate the part of our team as well to ZVADES? I don't know what that means. Like relocate meaning you have to raise everyone's salaries or is it immigration costs or? Yeah, yeah, raise salary costs. I would not do that. I would not do that unless it's for that specific investor who's forcing you to go there. You can say, you know what, we're raising a million. But you want my whole team in the US?

[01:08:07 - 01:08:53]
actually then we need to raise two million. And you need to commit the first million. Yeah, because my round is one million. One million is for you because you want my team here, right? See what they say? And they're going to reverse and say maybe you should keep the team there. And here's five hundred cases. Do you feel, that's the most important question, Do you feel like you need to move the whole team there? Not the whole team. Like, there's many... So

much, so... You should not move there in your day. Mm-hmm. Correct. Okay, let's start asking.

[01:08:58 - 01:09:03]
Between a five and a break. Yes. Go outside, get some air, jump up.

[01:09:13 - 01:09:16]
I want to ask what's the best way for me to come to the gym with some of my own.

Session 3: Customer value propositions and workshops

Source: GMT20260928-093125_Recording_1920x1080.mp4

Recording duration: 00:25:06. Times below are local to this recording.

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[00:00:00 - 00:00:47]
Hello. I feel like we're very lucky that it's still like long-pitched. Mm-hmm. Mm-hmm. Okay, good. Yeah. Okay. How do you know? Great, good time. Okay, 15 minutes and then we're going to work on your ITPs and value props because you need to have all of your value props by tomorrow, for my session tomorrow. So we're going to finish them before we're going to talk about them or we'll bring them tomorrow and talk to your way to your channel for today.

[00:00:48 - 00:01:33]
Yeah? A value proposition from our website or something different? We'll discuss. Yeah. Okay. You will see. Okay. You will see. Okay, coffee people, can you hear? Yeah? Ready? I know the coffee thing is so annoying. Not that it's you, it's just that coffee thing is chaos. We can think of people's loud. Yeah, put it on your phone. Or you get a new one that's so loud. It's like the loudest coffee I've ever been in my life. So long. Okay, so we're going to talk about customer value propositions. You have your value proposition on your website and the one that like describes you, but I want to talk about them from my customer review. Who has seen this chart before?

[00:01:33 - 00:02:18]
B2B elements of value. No? Okay, great. So, it's from the Harvard Business Review. We have a B2B one and then we'll talk about the consumer one after because usually you guys will be selling to a business but you'll also have end users and they care about different things. And so when we're talking about value propositions, when you talk about the value that you bring, when you talk about your features, when you talk about functionality, it should all tie to value. I never want to hear any of you say ever again, now that we've had this discussion, I never want you to say we do this thing on our website. Like we have a really cool technical product. We allow you to see user engagement, right?

[00:02:19 - 00:03:07]
Like cool, okay, you can like see this thing, but what does that do for me? Right? What is the value that you're actually bringing me? Anytime you're going to talk about a feature, anytime you're going to talk about functionality, you tell me what it does for the customer. I do not care what the feature does if it's not tied to value, right? And so let's look at our elements of value, right? if you guys will look here or on your um if you have a pdf of it or the slides on your screen you can look at your screen to look at this because i know it's a little small to fit on the screen like the very bottom right are like the minimum things that you have to have in the business right so like does it meet our specifications is an acceptable price do you comply with regulations and like do you have ethical standards like does it go against the things those are the very basic needs right that you're like meeting and then when we're going up and we're thinking about

[00:03:07 - 00:03:53]
other things are that you're helping the business do that you're helping the decision maker people accomplish or get to right they're accomplishing something they have goals they have ppis they have a problem what are they trying to do with that are they thinking about their economic value are they improving their top line are they reducing costs that's usually what people align with right they're either making money or they're saving money yeah are these things that we need to put on the website So these should be in all of your communications for all of eternity. So anytime you talk to a customer, when you reach out an email outreach, if you send a LinkedIn message, when you're talking to them at conferences, when you're communicating it all with any customer, you should be communicating the value that you're bringing to them.

[00:03:54 - 00:04:40]
Right? With any functionality, anything you have should always be the value, right? Never ever, ever, if here's our features, it should always be, our feature gives you this. Our feature brings you this. You're able to do Y with this feature, right, with this functionality. And so, yes, it should be, it'll probably be on some content on your website when you're talking about the value you're bringing to customers, not as your, like, main value prop, right, that you have, but

in a lot of content you create, like, in any of your sales decks, in any of your marketing content, if you have webinars, if you do things, right, you're always speaking to the value that you're bringing, yeah? biggest differentiator because so many people don't do this right you'll see so many startups that are just like here's a list of features you're like well what is it what does it give the customer why do they care about it right okay so is it saving the money is it making the money

[00:04:40 - 00:05:29]
performance is it helping with their product quality right do they have a problem with their product quality is it helping with scalability right are they growing really quickly and they have a scaling problem and your product is going to help them scale does it help with innovation do they want to be most innovative do they want to be most inventive are they doing the most like to them right and then we're going up we have like operational so organization simplification connection integration can help them with any of those things productivity is a time saving less effort decreased hassle information transparency that's the hardest one to sell right it's hard to sell people on we'll save you time we'll do things right like you usually have to tie in a few more things you're not just picking one you're going to pick a couple of these right and i'll have an example of someone after this. We have access. Are you giving them access to things they didn't have access to before?

[00:05:30 - 00:06:15]
The relationship, right? Are you giving them expertise, right? Are they trying to go to a new market or go to a new place that like your product will help them access a different market in a different way because you have expertise they don't have, they want to sell. maybe they're right labeling you right and give them expertise that they don't have to be able to sell something else um is it a stability right is it a commitment is it responsiveness like what are you building on to give them that they don't already have what they're looking for higher up right personal right sometimes like when i mentioned like if there's a new vp of sales coming in and like 90 days to prove themselves right 90 days they can pretty much buy anything do anything and they get a pass because like they're just going and making change in the first 90 days

[00:06:15 - 00:07:05]
so for them like it's very important to show things maybe they're like okay i need to show my value i care about implementing some new things to show some quick wins because that's what i care about right and so thinking about like is there growth and development is there like reducing anxiety because like they came in and came in to solve problems usually right we hire someone higher you're like you're coming in to fix something you're coming in to like grow the team you're coming in to do something what are you aligning with what can you align with that's in that like personal area right maybe it's design and aesthetics could be a lot of things career network expansion right are you helping them with the network expansion by doing this in some way marketability um reputational assurance right maybe a big partner or someone else they're like now we have this technical backbone we didn't have something something right maybe that's all you will and then the top vision hope social responsibility like right tying into any of those

[00:07:07 - 00:07:55]
to some of these things. At least one, usually more than one. Right? Usually four or five are tying into, you're helping the customer. So everything that you say in terms of your features or functionality should tie into the value. And I'll give you examples to show you what I mean. But I have the user one also. Because some of you are VC, but also the one I was talking about, that B2B element of value, right, is for like the business and the main person you're talking to. But your end users, right, the people that are actually using it, if you're B2B or just if you are B2B but your users are actually like consumers, right, people using the product, like they also care about other things, right, like I'm only going to use this product that my company bought if it's going to help me, right, I'm not going to use it if it's not going to help me in some way, so how is it helping me as the end user, right, and so you're

[00:07:55 - 00:08:40]
thinking about from the business perspective, what is the value that I'm bringing and also from your actual user perspective, like what value are you bringing to them, right, because you usually are with the budget, you're selling everyone that's using your product, right? Yeah, that's a question. I think because our client is companies and our end user is like their client, their potential client and we can communicate through the value for the company like I don't know, probably a pipeline, something like that. And we can also communicate just about like, give every visitor like them on something like that from their user perspective. Yeah.

[00:08:40 - 00:09:29]
You'll have to have both. Both. OK. OK. Because it depends on what they're trying to solve about their pain point. Is there a pain point that people coming to our website are not getting a good experience, and they have a big drop off rate, and they want to fix it? Is there a problem that their salespeople have too many leads that are bad and they want to meet some of them out? That's why it's really important to know the problem you're solving because the messaging you use, right? One is we're going to fix the traffic on your website and get conversion, right? And one is we're going to fix all the time your salespeople spend, like talking to people that are good fix. They can spend more time on good fix, right? Those are two different messagings, right? And I don't have a problem with one. I don't want you to message me about that, right? If my problem is not my market traffic, if my problem, right, and like people converting to downloads, if my problem is like my sales people have too many, don't tell me about the other one.

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I don't care. Right? You're going to lose me and we're going to stop paying attention because that's not the problem I have. Right? So for the B to C one, right, when we're thinking about the individual, right, functional at the bottom, what does it do for them? Does it save them time? Does it simplify? Does it make money? Reduce risk? Does it organize? Integrate? Connect? Reduce effort? Hustle? Cost? Quality? What does it do? Like, right? How do you help them? It's a very basic, a lot of them will fall to the bottom, right? Because people at work are like functionally trying to make things better.

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then going up is it emotional right does it reduce anxiety does it reward me is it wellness is it fun is it nostalgic is it like designed really well right if you're selling to like product teams um and design teams there it's not designed really well but probably not because they like care very much about that right if something beautifully designed they'll give it a try even if it maybe doesn't have as much functionality as other things because that's what they care about right versus if you're like a work really well yes or no i have her looks like what i really don't care does it work better than other ones like play is not beautifully fine play is like it right and they were in spreadsheets for such a long time you just get to have it in spreadsheets and i was like that's not even fancy design but very functional right um and then i was like life changing is it changing some things

[00:10:46 - 00:11:32]
um think about those things most of you are going to fall in the lower too right for your end users but like maybe you'll you'll get some of the other ones you can right um so we're thinking and the value we're providing and then we're thinking about the end user and the value we're providing and then we need to put them into words so we want to talk about Ardzen who knows Ardzen only help people okay well Ardzen is like a AI DDR they're very aggressive with ads all over the place we've come to the simon-sist field they're always like flying around with things very aggressive The excuse for this campaign that fire your... Fire your... The excuse for that, the one's close. Yes, which was very aggressive. A little controversial and I think he had a higher security system, death threats, it was like very aggressive.

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But anyway, AIBDR, right? And so they help revenue teams automate up on sales with Ava, an AI sales agent, she finds leads, enriches them, prioritizes them, writes outreach, and replies and goes to meetings. That's functionally what the product does, right? want to take that and we're going to say what is the value that this is actually providing this is functionally the product this is how a lot of you are talking about your value drop right is you're like here are all of the things that we do here's the functions here's the features here's what it does but we want to think about this is why we talked about stakeholders and our icps is because we care about who we're selling to what they care about what their priorities are right and they're different and we want to go back to our volumes of value and we want to think about how we help them And so for Artisan, Artisan saves time and automates prospect research, enrichment, follow-up, and books meetings, so sales can spend less time on manual work.

[00:12:26 - 00:13:11]
Artisan avoids hassles by replacing a fragmented outbound stack with one platform for B2B data, campaign execution, deliverability, and booking. Artisan simplifies by letting teams define an outbound strategy once and having a good run the workflow end to end. Artisan informs by prioritizing leads based on intent signals such as funding rounds, helping teams focus on better time opportunities. And Ava makes money by helping teams generate more pipeline and book more meetings through automated outbound meetings more close and grow deals. Right? That's

what Artisan does. Right? But do you see the difference between functionally what Artisan did and here's actually the value that I get by using Artisan. Right? And those are very different. Right? If you read this, you're like, oh, I see how this could help me do these things. Right?

[00:13:12 - 00:13:58]
And then we're thinking about, I'm our end user. Right? Can we go back for a review? It seems a little bit ironized and structured. Like everything. Like what? Like everything. They produce everything. Shall it be more focused? OK, we say goodbye. Well, you want to have a bunch of things that depends on your ICP. because it depends on who you're going after. You should have a bunch because you're like, for this ICP, here's what we help you on. For this ICP with this problem, here's what we help you do. And so you have all of these, but not as a customer, I don't care about all of them at any one time. I have a problem I want to solve. And so one of these, maybe two of these, is like the problem that I have specifically. But if you don't have this messaging

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for how it's going to help me and you give me a different messaging, I don't care then. Then you don't seem like the product for me. And so I want you to be thinking about, So, this is why we're talking about ICP's first. ICP's, right? And then the stakeholders and the customers that you're talking to. Because depending on who you're talking to, depending on your ICP, you're going to talk about what you do functionally very different and the values they get very differently. Right? And yeah. And how to choose, for example, only one value proposition because they are like kind of five problems, five how they help to solve this problem. For example, we have different customers, it's different problems. Some of them suffer from not enough pipelines, some of them suffer like,

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oh, it's too many for our sales team and we hire more. How to prioritize it? But those would be different ICPs that you're identifying, right? So you might have a different landing page for different workflows, for different marketing campaigns you're running. Right, you're like this content is for people whose sales teams have too many leads that have like a lot of junk leads and the sales teams are really angry because they're not quite able to prioritize good leads. Right, and then you have a campaign around that and you're like we think this ICP people that are hiring more than five PDRs have this problem. Right, and then that's what you target with that messaging. Right, because you're very specific about the pain that they have and the problem that you're solving for them. Because they don't care about simplifying the album.

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They don't care about that at all. Don't talk about that. Doesn't matter. And you have different messaging on your website. You have your main messaging, but then you have for teams that are trying to optimize their sales funnel, for teams that are trying to work on their marketing flow. Because you're speaking to those different ICPs and you have to speak to them in a different way. Or else it doesn't resonate. right yeah is it a good idea to create the like let's say dedicated pages by like sizes or sensors or cases a very uh a big example if you've gone to see twilio's website because they they do it very aggressively you don't have to do it that much right but it's like for schools for governments for things but then they're like for this specific problem for this specific problem this problem like for this solution for this solution for this solution so like you can go very far we don't i

[00:16:24 - 00:17:11]
I would go as far as them, right? Like that's very aggressive, but they're like, for any use case or instance, however you want to search, we will like to search that way. Yeah, for example, not at all. But it's also when people go to your website, if they don't see their exact use case and problem, they go somewhere else. Right? Because don't make them imagine feeling, maybe I could use this product in this way. Some people will probably support you, but not a lot of them. A lot of them, this isn't for me. Go somewhere else. Right? If they can discover, is this page from the main page? Because they need to feel like your solution is for them. Right? You're solving their exact problem. Okay, so we have the customer value propositions. I want to do the end user one as well, right?

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So for our end user for Artisan, for the sales teams that are using it, right? It saves time by handling cross-fitting, enrichment, and follow-up. So reps can spend more time on live opportunities and closing. Artisan simplifies, rubs no longer need to jump between multiple tools for contacts, enrichment, sequencing, and booking. Artisan reduces effort because they were researched as prospects and has personalized outreach using CRM data, reducing repetitive manual work. That's great for sales teams, good sales teams. Artisan improves confidence, intense cycles of enrichment, helps teams understand who to contact and why. When we're thinking about what is the value of the end

user is or why someone should use it, when you're onboarding, when a lot of you are onboarding teams, because sometimes there'll be a couple, let's use the art as an example,

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when they're selling to the VP of sales, and selling to it, the director likes it, maybe the RedOps person is like, great, this is a good fit, and maybe they'll bring in an enterprise AE or one of the other AE's to be like, do you think this is a good fit? And they'll be like, yeah, sure, let's try it. And then you have to get the rest of the team on board and your onboarding for those reps should tell them exactly what is going to help them. Right? Because they should understand like, how's this going to help me? Why should I use it? Why should I take the time to onboard and use this new tool? Right? Because it's going to help them. Yeah? And for messaging for those people too. For the sales people, right? When they're bringing it on. This is for anything. Right? You should have, here's how it helps the company. Here's how it helps the end user. And then you need to connect them. And then you need to constantly be reiterating how helpful it is. Right? And the value that you're bringing to them. Okay.

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So then we're creating our customer value propositions, right? I put them together, just some lovely sentences for you, right? For the economic buyer, Artisan helps sales leaders generate more pipeline, reduce outbound costs, we can consolidate the sales stack in one platform. Ava can automate outbound and customers get a lower cost per lead and new revenue from outbound campaigns. For the end user, Artisan helps SDRs that use in rub ops save time, reduce manual work, simplify execution, focus on better opportunities, while Ava handles prospecting enrichment outreach Okay, yeah. So now we're going to do that ourselves. Okay, go by and lay in court. Do you guys understand and see why those are important and why CEPs are more important in the future? For the students to their problem.

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For the students to their problem. And how they're different for each specific ICP? And why we're doing it in this order? Yes? Excited about ICPs? Okay, so now, so what I want you guys to do by tomorrow, because tomorrow we're going to talk about outreach, which you'll be using your value props in, and discovery calls, which you'll also be using your value props in, because that's how you're going to communicate value, right? And all of your calls. So we need you to have your ICPs. I want you to have five to seven ICPs. You can make three that you're going after now, but I want you to have at least seven. I want

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you to also have value drops oh okay No, I want you to have ICPs. Was it for cells? No, I want you to have ICPs. ICPs? Yeah. Including buyer titles. Yeah, titles. Inside the ICP. I want your ICP to be so detailed that you can take the ICP you want and give it to any other team and that team can go and find those exact people. That's how detailed your ICP should be. Yes? Okay, so ICPs to get. We're plotting on mapping them. You don't in your head. Buying and selling process, I want you to know to have what you know and what you

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don't know and what you need to find out and maybe you can write out some of the customer interview questions for things you don't know about the buying process for some of those ICPs that you need to identify and find out and then I want you to think about the stakeholder relationships. If you do a couple of these and map them where they are and map them out for companies, that will be easier for me to also understand who you're talking to. Some of you have asked who is the title of the I don't know the person that we're talking to as our customer bring the titles of the people and know where they live and know who else you don't know right so we can map them out to talk to them um and think about how we talk to them and then personas I want you to or sorry um I want you to take all of these um the elements of value and I want you to think about which ones apply to you

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which ones apply um to your customers and have a group of them um probably at least four you'll right for values from b to b side for different icps for the three icps that you definitely want to go after the value propositions of them whether it's just the business or the business and the end user yes yes this is by tomorrow not not for this hour no if you want me to look at it in this hour absolutely i will but have it for tomorrow so we can think about it for outreach because they'll be writing some outreach and thinking about your icp in the morning and in afternoon we're doing discovery and then we're gonna do some practice discovery calls you need to have your icp do they need to tell me

how i'm going to be yeah so is it i should be

[00:22:24 - 00:23:11]
stakeholders stakeholders are mapping and your buying process if you don't know things about them the the actual tangible things that i want to see are your icps and your value props the other ones are for you if you want to map out your stakeholders in the buying and selling process you should have internally but I need you to have the ICPs and the body props are smart. Okay. Yes? Questions? Full of doing excitement? Yes. Okay, great. Perfect. So we have one hour to office hours. So we can be outside because it's a lovely day if you guys don't want your body props and ICPs out there or you can stay in here. I'll be outside to find me if you want to talk about them, if you want to bring some of my TPs, if you want me to look at your belly crops,

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if you want to talk to the customer belly crops. I will get it. Sound good? Yeah. Great. Thank you guys. Thank you. Of course. Yeah. Where do you find this link? I think it's up to the other group.

[00:24:03 - 00:24:05]
Okay.

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Thank you.

[00:24:52 - 00:24:55]
Thank you.